

MOVEMENTAL · ONBOARDED LEADER RESEARCH

Digital Reality Profile: Dhati Lewis

Movement leader research dossier — profile, content catalog, digital presence, fragmentation story, and onboarding materials.

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At a Glance — Summary

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Digital Reality Profile: Dhati Lewis

Dhati Lewis is an Atlanta-based church planter, author, and disciple-making leader — founder of Blueprint Church, founder/president of the Rebuild Initiative (MyBLVD), and former Vice President and President of the North American Mission Board's Send Network. His published and spoken work centers on disciple-making in the urban context, the church as family, and a Christ-centered "narrow path" to racial reconciliation. His content is substantive and coherent but distributed across many disconnected surfaces.

Executive Summary

Across two major books (Among Wolves, 2017; Advocates, 2019), a companion Bible study, three hosted podcasts, and years of conference teaching, Lewis has built a coherent body of disciple-making and reconciliation work. The challenge is not message clarity but consolidation: his corpus lives in silos (personal site, Blueprint, MyBLVD, multiple podcast platforms, publisher and speaker pages), with no single searchable home.

Current Digital Presence

- **Personal:** dhatilewis.com ("Teaching Christian Leaders to Navigate the Cultural Divide")
- **Church:** blueprintchurch.org
- **Initiative:** myblvd.co
- **Social:** Instagram [@dhati.lewis](https://www.instagram.com/dhati.lewis) (~3,592, unconfirmed); X [@dhati](https://twitter.com/dhati); Facebook; YouTube [@wheRelifeexists](https://www.youtube.com/channel/UCwheRelifeexists)
- **Publisher / author pages:** B&H, Amazon, Goodreads

Content Landscape

- **Books:** Advocates (2019), Among Wolves (2017) + Bible study + leader kit, In Plain Sight (reported 2013), foreword to Responsible Sibling.
- **Audio:** Hosts Where Life Exists, MyBLVD Podcast (with Missie Branch), We Are Send Network.
- **Articles:** ERLC, MyBLVD, Saturate, Outreach, Christian Post.
- **Speaking:** T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential, Moody Audio.

Discoverability Assessment

Strong publisher-backed discoverability for the two B&H books and consistent presence on church-planting platform sites. Weak points: no Wikipedia page; In Plain Sight has no retail ISBN/page; the podcast catalogue is split across Podbean, iHeart, Apple, and YouTube; named frameworks are not consolidated into linkable references.

Gap Analysis (factual state only)

Asset	State
Unified content home	None — corpus spread across 5+ domains
Wikipedia page	None found
In Plain Sight retail listing	No ISBN/publisher page located
Audiobook editions	Not confirmed for any title
Consolidated podcast archive	None — episodes split across platforms
Academic publications	None found

Movemental Opportunities

A consolidated, searchable surface for the disciple-making and reconciliation corpus, with the named frameworks as first-class references and the podcast/teaching catalogue unified into one discoverable archive.

What We Will NOT Do

- We will not fabricate metrics, dates, ISBNs, or quotes.
- We will not assign a fit score, NOTs assessment, or revenue projection here (those are separate consulting artifacts).
- We will not rely on advocacy/oppositional sources for factual claims.

Author Profile — Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/profile/identity.md

Identity Verification: Dhati Lewis

Canonical Identity

Field	Value	Source
Full name	Dhati Lewis (middle name "Baraka" appears on his personal Facebook — self-published, probable not authoritative)	facebook.com/dhati.lewis
Known as	Dhati Lewis	dhatilewis.com/about
Born	Date/year unknown (not published)	—
Birthplace / upbringing	Born and raised in California; son of an NFL player	plantmidwest.com
Current location	Atlanta, Georgia	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Nationality	American	—
Heritage	Black / African American	Among Wolves (Amazon)
Primary roles	Founding/lead pastor, Blueprint Church; Founder & President, Rebuild Initiative / MyBLVD; former VP → President, Send Network (NAMB)	dhatilewis.com/about
Spouse	Angie (Angela) Lewis	blueprintchurch.org/angela-lewis
Children	Six named — Trinity, Jade, Briaiah, Dhati, Brayden, Nathaniel (one bio says "seven")	authenticmanhood.com

Disambiguation

"Dhati" is a rare given name; the pastor dominates all search results. Reliable modifiers that uniquely retrieve him: **"Blueprint Church"**, **"Send Network" / "NAMB"**, **"Among Wolves"**, **"Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation"**, **"MyBLVD" / "Rebuild Initiative"**.

A "Dhati Lewis" college-football entry exists on Sports-Reference (page blocked, 403) and **may be the same person** given his UNT football background — confirm before merging. Unrelated namesakes that surface in search (D.D. Lewis, Damione Lewis — NFL players) are **not** him.

Education

Institution	Credential	Years	Source
University of North Texas	B.A. (football scholarship; later football chaplain)	unknown	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Dallas Theological Seminary	M.A. in Cross-Cultural Ministry	unknown	bhpublishinggroup.com
Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary	D.Min. in Great Commission Mobilization	~2016–2017 (described as "most recently received" in 2017)	bhpublishinggroup.com

Career Timeline (summary)

Founded Blueprint Church, Atlanta (2009) → launched Rebuild Network (2011) → published *Among Wolves* (2017) → voted VP of Send Network, NAMB (Oct 2, 2018) → published *Advocates* (2019), launched Send Network–NAAF partnership → served as President of Send Network → departed NAMB to launch BLVD/MyBLVD (end of 2021) → continues as Blueprint lead pastor + Rebuild Initiative president (2022–). Full detail in [biography.md](#).

Family & Personal

Married to Angie (Angela) Lewis; six named children (Trinity, Jade, Briaiah, Dhati, Brayden, Nathaniel). Self-describes on social media as "Husband of one, Father of many." Came up through football (NFL-player father; UNT scholarship) before a vocation toward urban disciple-making.

Published Works

- *Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation* (B&H, 2019)
- *Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City* (B&H, 2017) + LifeWay Bible Study Book & Leader Kit
- *In Plain Sight: A Primer for Reclaiming Discipleship in the Local Church* (Rebuild Network, reported 2013)
- Foreword to *Responsible Sibling* by Jorge Mendoza

See [../content/books.md](#) for full bibliographic detail.

Biography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/profile/biography.md

Biography: Dhati Lewis

Narrative Biography

Dhati Lewis is the founding pastor of Blueprint Church in Atlanta, the founder and president of the Rebuild Initiative (MyBLVD), and the former Vice President and President of the North American Mission Board's Send Network. Born and raised in California as the son of an NFL player, he came to Texas on a football scholarship to the University of North Texas, where an emerging call to ministry — through football chaplaincy and college ministry — set him on a path toward urban disciple-making. After a Master's in Cross-Cultural Ministry at Dallas Theological Seminary and a Doctor of Ministry at Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary, he moved to Atlanta in 2009 with roughly twenty-five others to plant Blueprint Church on the conviction that the church "is not like family; it is family," and that disciple-making — not church-planting — is the true engine of multiplication.

Origin & Formation

Raised in California in the home of a former NFL player, Lewis pursued football to the collegiate level at the University of North Texas. His ministry formation began in that collegiate world — serving as a chaplain to the UNT football team, coaching, and moving into college pastoring — before he planted a church in Texas and pursued graduate theological education (Dallas Theological Seminary; later Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary). (blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis)

Career & Ministry Arc

- **2009** — Moved to Atlanta with ~25 others; founded Blueprint Church (launched downtown 2010).
- **2011** — Launched the Rebuild Network to plant multi-ethnic churches in urban contexts; began partnering with NAMB's Send North America strategy.
- **2017** — Published *Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City* (B&H), with a companion LifeWay Bible study and leader kit.
- **Oct 2018** — Voted Vice President of Send Network by NAMB trustees, succeeding Jeff Christopherson.
- **2019** — Published *Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation* (B&H); launched the Send Network-NAAF (National African American Fellowship) church-planting partnership.
- **~2019-2021** — Served as President of Send Network (~3 years leading the network).

- **End of 2021** — Departed NAMB to launch BLVD/MyBLVD under the Rebuild Initiative; succeeded as Send Network president by Vance Pitman.
- **2022-** — Continues as Blueprint's lead/vision pastor and founder/president of the Rebuild Initiative (MyBLVD Experience, MyBLVD Family, Known 360).

(baptistpress.com, namb.net)

Current Focus

Lewis pastors Blueprint Church and leads the Rebuild Initiative / MyBLVD, an effort to "empower disciple-makers in majority-minority, multiethnic communities" and to develop and mentor young leaders who will plant churches in the urban context. He hosts the Where Life Exists and MyBLVD podcasts and teaches across the church-planting ecosystem (Together for the Gospel, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential). (dhatilewis.com/about)

Key Relationships & Influences

- **Jeff Christopherson** — predecessor at Send Network whom Lewis served under for several years.
- **Kevin Ezell** — NAMB president who championed the NAMB-Rebuild partnership.
- **Larry Grays** — Rebuild Initiative VP; pastor of Midtown Bridge Church, Atlanta.
- **Vance Pitman** — successor as Send Network president; publicly endorsed by Lewis.
- **Missie Branch** — co-host of the MyBLVD Podcast.

See ../network/organizations.md for the full relational map.

In Their Own Words

"We need to be careful with ministry because sometimes our gifts will take us to places that our character can't handle." — Among Wolves

"We wanted to establish a blueprint... a church that's planting other churches because we want to be a church that's going to be the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship." — Where Ya From? Ep. 56 (2023)

Theological Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/profile/theology.md

Theological Profile: Dhati Lewis

Core Thesis

Disciple-making — not church-planting — is the engine of the church's mission, and the church is best understood as family. "If you plant a church you are not guaranteed to make disciples, but if you make disciples the logical result is" a church/family. Out of this flows a vision for the urban context: to be "the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship." (saturatetheworld.com, namb.net)

Theological Tradition

Southern Baptist (SBC). Trained at Dallas Theological Seminary (M.A.) and Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary (D.Min.); leadership tenure at NAMB/Send Network situates him squarely in conservative evangelical SBC church-planting streams. No explicit "Reformed" self-identification was found in sources reviewed. (newchurches.com)

Key Frameworks & Models

- **Advocate vs. Aggravator** (Advocates, 2019): an advocate pursues reconciliation by (1) relying on Christ, (2) running to the tension, (3) responding with dignity; an aggravator deepens division out of self-interest. Drawn exegetically from Philemon.
- **Eight Movements in Matthew** (Among Wolves, 2017): a disciple-making culture built by tracing eight movements in Matthew's Gospel.
- **Church as Family**: identity and belonging precede activity; "the church is not like family; it is family."
- **The 7 Steps of an Urban Missionary** (MyBLVD Podcast): a teaching arc on the formation of an urban missionary.

Full detail in [../content/frameworks.md](https://github.com/dhati-lewis/content/blob/master/frameworks.md).

Distinctive Positions

- The church is literally family, not merely like family.
- Disciple-making is primary; church-planting is its logical result, not its precondition.
- Racial reconciliation is a Christ-centered "narrow path" of advocacy, distinct from politically-driven "aggravation"; heart posture precedes political positioning, and all parties share responsibility for reconciliation regardless of blame distribution.

- Mission happens "where life exists" — in the majority-minority urban context that the church has too often abandoned.

Intellectual Genealogy

- **Upstream:** Jeff Christopherson (Send Network missiology, served under him); Kevin Ezell (NAMB Send North America strategy). Theological training at Dallas Theological Seminary and Southeastern. Named authorial mentors are not documented in available sources.
- **Downstream:** Rebuild Network church plants; ethnic diversification of Send Network church planters; Send Network–NAAF partnership; mentoring of urban church planters via BLVD/MyBLVD.

Theological Evolution

His thought moves from a primer on reclaiming local-church discipleship (In Plain Sight, reported 2013) → a developed disciple-making ecclesiology rooted in Matthew (Among Wolves, 2017) → an applied theology of racial reconciliation rooted in Philemon (Advocates, 2019) → an institutional expression in Send Network leadership and now a mentoring/formation focus through BLVD/MyBLVD. The through-line is constant: disciple-making and church-as-family carried into the urban, multiethnic context.

Vocational Profile

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/profile/calling-profile.md

Dhati Lewis: Calling Profile & Audit

Executive Summary

Dhati Lewis is a movement-level church planter and disciple-making practitioner whose calling centers on keeping the church present in the urban, majority-minority context that it has too often abandoned. From founding Blueprint Church in Atlanta (2009) to leading the North American Mission Board's Send Network (2018-2021) to launching the Rebuild Initiative / MyBLVD, his vocational arc has consistently fused theology, mission, and context — refusing to choose between them. His calling statement, in his own words, is to help raise "the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship."

Calling Statement

To make disciples who make disciples in the city — establishing the church as family, multiplying multiethnic urban congregations, and mentoring the next generation of urban missionaries so that sound discipleship no longer requires leaving the urban context.

mDNA Alignment Profile

mDNA Element	Evidence	Strength
Jesus is Lord / Disciple-Making	Entire ministry is built on disciple-making as the engine; Among Wolves is a disciple-making manifesto	Very strong
Missional-Incarnational Impulse	Embeds the church in the urban context "where life exists"; refuses to flee the city	Very strong
Apostolic Environment	Founded a church-planting network (Rebuild) and led a national one (Send Network)	Strong
Organic Systems	"Church as family"; identity/belonging before infrastructure	Strong
Communitas (liminality + togetherness)	"Run to the tension"; disciple-making "among wolves"	Strong
APEST	Functions apostolically (planting, multiplying); evangelistic and teaching gifts evident	Moderate-strong (documented apostolic/teaching; full APEST profile not self-stated)

Movement Leadership Map

- **Local:** Blueprint Church (founder/lead pastor) — a disciple-making, church-planting congregation.
- **Network:** Rebuild Initiative / Rebuild Network (founder) — multi-ethnic urban church planting.
- **National:** Send Network / NAMB (former VP → President) — national church-planting infrastructure; drove ethnic diversity and the NAAF partnership.
- **Formation:** BLVD / MyBLVD — mentoring and developing young urban-context leaders.

Content-Calling Alignment Analysis

Lewis's published content maps tightly to his calling: Among Wolves (disciple-making in the city) and Advocates (reconciliation / multiethnic church) are direct expressions of his vocation, and his podcasts (Where Life Exists, MyBLVD) extend the same themes into ongoing teaching. The alignment between what he is called to and what he produces is high; the gap is one of consolidation and reach (see [../summary.md](#)), not of message coherence.

Digital Calling Opportunity Map

His calling is well-served by a unified disciple-making/urban-mission body of work, but that work is currently scattered across a personal site, two org sites (Blueprint, MyBLVD), multiple podcast hubs, and several speaker pages. A consolidated, searchable home for the disciple-making frameworks, reconciliation teaching, and urban-missionary formation arc would most directly amplify the calling. (Factual fragmentation detail in [../fragmentation-story.md](#).)

Strategic Recommendations

- Consolidate the disciple-making and reconciliation corpus into one canonical, searchable surface.
- Make the named frameworks (Advocate/Aggravator, Eight Movements, 7 Stops of an Urban Missionary) first-class, linkable references.
- Capture the podcast/teaching catalogue (currently spread across Podbean, iHeart, Apple, YouTube) into a single discoverable archive.

Related Documentation

- [../summary.md](#) — Digital Reality Profile
- [../fragmentation-story.md](#) — The Fragmentation Story
- [theology.md](#) · [voice-analysis.md](#)

Voice & Editorial Identity

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/profile/voice-analysis.md

Voice Analysis: Dhati Lewis

Voice Summary

Dhati Lewis writes and speaks as an urban pastor-practitioner: framework-driven, exegetically anchored, and grounded in personal testimony. He packages teaching into memorable, often triadic schemes ("rely on Christ, run to the tension, respond with dignity"), builds whole books on a single biblical book (Matthew; Philemon), and addresses the reader directly as a fellow practitioner. His signature rhetorical move is to name a binary — context vs. theology, comfort vs. obedience, fleeing vs. staying — and refuse to resolve it by choosing a side, instead calling the listener to "run to the tension."

Attribute	Value
Tone	Earnest, pastoral, conviction-driven; warm but direct
Register	Accessible practitioner prose; code-switches into spoken Black-church cadence in interviews
Person	Second person ("you, pastor / leader / practitioner") and first-person testimony
Structure	Triadic, sequential, framework-scaffolded

Recurring phrases: "disciple-making", "run to the tension", "the church as family", "the last generation to leave the urban context", "navigate the cultural divide", "respond with dignity"

Favorite metaphors: **family** (the church as literal family), **the city / boulevard ("where life exists")**, **the narrow path** (reconciliation), **wolves** (the hostile environment of urban disciple-making)

Writing Characteristics

1. **Triadic, framework-driven structure** — teaching arrives as memorable three-part schemes (advocates "rely on Christ, run to the tension, respond with dignity").
2. **Exegetical anchoring** — a whole book built on one biblical book, with chapter-and-verse cited inline.
3. **Narrative / personal testimony** — opens from autobiography (NFL aspirations → conversion → call to the city) before moving to teaching.
4. **Direct second-person address** — speaks straight to "pastor, leader, practitioner."
5. **Conversational/vernacular register** — code-switches into spoken Black-church cadence in interviews, distinct from his more formal prose.

Signature Patterns

The **"both/and tension as the doorway to mission"** move: he frames a binary, refuses to resolve it by picking a pole, and calls the listener to stay in / run toward the tension.

Reinforced by the recurring "run to the tension" formula and alliterative triads.

Representative quotes

"Cities are not only diverse culturally, but also socioeconomically. In urban settings, in a one-mile area, one can see extreme poverty intertwined with extreme wealth..." — Among Wolves

"And many of us define God's will by the path of least resistance... our North Stars are comfort, and we're addicted to our comfort." — Where Ya From? Ep. 56

"It was like either I was around people who got my context but didn't have that same commitment to theology and mission, or I was around people who got my mission in theology, but they didn't get my context." — Where Ya From? Ep. 56

Speaking vs. Writing

In print his register is more formal and exegetical; in interviews and from the platform he code-switches into a vernacular, spoken-Black-church cadence ("they ain't talking about this") and leans harder on testimony and call-and-response rhythm. The frameworks stay constant across both modes.

Vocabulary and Terminology Preferences

disciple-making · disciple-makers · the city / urban context / majority-minority places · urban missionary · run to the tension · advocate / the ministry of reconciliation · respond with dignity · rely on Christ · the church as family · navigate the cultural divide · holistic disciple-makers · "the last generation to leave the urban context"

Bibliography

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/books.md

Bibliography: Dhati Lewis

Books newest-first. ISBN-13s verified against publisher/retail pages where available.

Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation

Field	Value
Author	Dhati Lewis (sole)
Publisher	B&H Books
Published	2019
ISBN-13	9781535934671 (hardcover); 9781535934688 (ebook)
Pages	160
Goodreads	4.07 avg, 175 ratings
URL	Amazon · Christianbook

Description: Using Paul's letter to Philemon, Lewis argues that Christians must become advocates — not aggravators — pursuing racial reconciliation by relying on Christ, running to the tension, and responding with dignity.

Key themes: racial reconciliation, advocacy, Philemon, heart posture over politics.

Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City

Field	Value
Author	Dhati Lewis (sole)
Publisher	B&H Books
Published	2017
ISBN-13	9781433644023 (ISBN-10 1433644029)
Pages	192
Goodreads	3.79 avg, 76 ratings
URL	B&H · Amazon

Description: Tracing eight movements in Matthew's Gospel, Lewis equips leaders to build a disciple-making culture that turns passive church participants into active disciple-makers in the city.

Key themes: disciple-making, urban/city ministry, church as family, mobilization.

Among Wolves — Bible Study Book: Disciple Making in the City

Field	Value
Author	Dhati Lewis
Publisher	LifeWay
Published	2017
ISBN-13	9781462742837
Format	8-session Bible study
URL	Amazon

Description: An eight-session small-group Bible study companion to Among Wolves.

Among Wolves — Leader Kit: Disciple Making in the City

Field	Value
Author	Dhati Lewis
Publisher	LifeWay
Published	2017 (exact date unconfirmed)
ISBN-13	9781462742844
URL	Amazon

Description: Leader companion kit to the Among Wolves Bible study.

In Plain Sight: A Primer for Reclaiming Discipleship in the Local Church

Field	Value
Author	Dhati Lewis
Publisher	Rebuild Network (reported)
Published	2013 (reported, unconfirmed)
ISBN-13	unknown
Goodreads	4.50 avg, 2 ratings
URL	unknown (reportedly distributed as a free e-book)

Description: A precursor to Among Wolves; a primer on reclaiming local-church-centered discipleship. Year, publisher, and ISBN are unconfirmed by any retail/publisher page.

Forewords / contributions

- **Foreword** to Responsible Sibling: What it Means to Be A Brother's Keeper by Jorge Mendoza (The Blueprint Church Series), ISBN-13 9781546499428 — [Amazon](#). Not an authored title; extends his church-as-family theme.

Bibliography Summary

4 unique authored works (2 trade books + 1 Bible-study/leader-kit pair + 1 reported primer); all solo-authored; publishers B&H and LifeWay (2017) plus a reported 2013 Rebuild Network primer; ~256 total Goodreads ratings across all works. Sources: [Goodreads author page](#), [B&H](#).

Frameworks

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/frameworks.md

Frameworks: Dhati Lewis

Advocate vs. Aggravator

Field	Value
Introduced	2019, Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation
Components	(1) Rely on Christ; (2) Run to the tension; (3) Respond with dignity
Source text	Paul's letter to Philemon
Adoption evidence	Framing for Advocates (B&H, 2019); used in reconciliation teaching and conference talks
Source	baptistpress.com

An "advocate" pursues reconciliation; an "aggravator" deepens division out of self-interest, self-preservation, or self-vindication. The three marks of an advocate define a Christ-centered "narrow path" distinct from politically-driven aggravation.

The Eight Movements in Matthew (disciple-making model)

Field	Value
Introduced	2017, Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City
Components	Eight "movements" traced through Matthew's Gospel, from Jesus establishing His presence with His followers to mobilizing them to make disciples of all nations
Visual / model	Matthew's narrative arc
Adoption evidence	Basis of Among Wolves + the 8-session LifeWay Bible study + Leader Kit
Source	bhpublishinggroup.com

A disciple-making culture built by following eight movements in Matthew that turn passive participants into active disciple-makers in the city.

Church as Family (ecclesiology)

Field	Value
Introduced	Among Wolves (2017); articulated in his Saturate essay (2017)
Components	Identity precedes activity; establish belonging/family before infrastructure; "make disciples and a church is the logical result"
Adoption evidence	Blueprint Church discipleship strategy: "develop healthy people who are growing in the Gospel, in the context of family, while living on mission"
Source	saturatetheworld.com

"The church is not like family; it is family." Disciple-making, not church-planting, is the engine.

The 7 Steps of an Urban Missionary

Field	Value
Introduced	MyBLVD Podcast (with Missie Branch)
Components	A seven-stop sequence framing the formation of an "urban missionary" (individual stops not fully catalogued in available sources)
Visual / model	Podcast series arc
Adoption evidence	MyBLVD Podcast / Rebuild Initiative content
Source	myblvdpodcast.podbean.com

A named teaching arc on MyBLVD sequencing the journey of an urban missionary. Component detail is not fully documented — see [open questions in the substrate](#).

Articles & Blog Posts

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/articles.md

Articles & Blog Posts: Dhati Lewis

Article-level writing beyond books. Several author archives blocked direct fetch (HTTP 403), so individual titles could not always be enumerated; archive URLs are given.

Title / archive	Outlet	URL	Notes
Author archive (multiple pieces)	ERLC	https://erlc.com/multi_author/dhati-lewis/	Titles not enumerable (page blocked fetch)
Author archive	MyBLVD	https://myblvd.co/author/dhati/	His posts on the MyBLVD site
Author archive	Saturate (Saturate the World)	https://saturatetheworld.com/author/dhati/	Includes "Don't Just Start a Church, Establish a Family" (2017-07-20)
"Don't Just Start a Church, Establish a Family"	Saturate	https://saturatetheworld.com/2017/07/20/dont-just-start-church-establish-family/	Church-as-family essay
Advocates excerpt ("Voices")	Outreach Magazine	https://outreachmagazine.com/resources/voices/43872-dhati-lewis-advocates.html	Book excerpt (page 403 on fetch; exists per search)
"Creating Space for Change in Your Community"	Outreach Magazine	https://outreachmagazine.com/resources/conferences-and-events/79522-dhati-lewis-creating-space-for-change-in-your-community.html	Feature/interview
Interview: disciple-making in the urban context	Christian Post	https://www.christianpost.com/news/dhati-lewis-talks-disciple-making-in-the-urban-context.html	Feature interview

Themes

Disciple-making, church-as-family, urban mission, and racial reconciliation — the same themes as his books, in shorter form.

Notes

ERLC and Outreach author/landing pages returned HTTP 403, so a complete per-article enumeration was not possible. The archives above are confirmed to exist and host multiple pieces.

Audio & Podcast

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/audio.md

Audio Content: Dhati Lewis

Podcasts Hosted

Title	Role	Platform / URL	Notes
Where Life Exists	Host	https://www.dhatilewis.com/wherelifexists	Video podcast "about disciple making in the public square"; series include "Why I Stay" (minority leaders in predominantly white evangelical spaces). Guests named: Derwin Gray, William "Sho Baraka" Branch, Bryan Loritts, Karen Ellis
MyBLVD Podcast	Co-host (with Missie Branch)	https://myblvdpodcast.podbean.com/ · https://www.iheart.com/podcast/338-myblvd-podcast-116978610/	"The 7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" arc; recent episodes Jan-Apr 2025
We Are Send Network	Co-host (with Noah Oldham, Heiden Ratner)	https://podcasts.apple.com/bz/podcast/we-are-send-network/id1197627183	Send Network church-planting podcast

Guest Appearances

Episode Title	Show	Date	URL
A Blueprint for Discipleship in an Urban Context	Where Ya From? (Christianity Today)	2023-10-17	https://whereyafrom.org/episode/episode-56-a-blueprint-for-discipleship-in-an-urban-context-with-dhati-lewis/
Dhati Lewis on: Advocacy	The Gospel, Culture & Me	—	https://podtail.com/podcast/the-gospel-culture-me/ep-16-dhati-lewis-on-advocacy/

Recorded Teaching

- Moody Audio hosts recorded talks: <https://moodyaudio.com/person/dhati-lewis>

Notes

Episode totals for the three hosted podcasts are unknown (not enumerated by the platforms reached). Audio metrics (downloads/plays) are not publicly visible.

Video Content

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/videos.md

Video Content: Dhati Lewis

YouTube Channel

Channel	URL	Stats
Where Life Exists	https://www.youtube.com/@wherelifeexists (also youtube.com/c/WhereLifeExists)	Subscriber/view counts not visible (could not fetch channel stats)

Video Catalog

Title	Platform	Date	URL
Where Life Exists (video podcast)	YouTube / dhatilewis.com	—	https://www.dhatilewis.com/wherelifeexists
MyBLVD Podcast episodes	YouTube	2025	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=iv0Of94BSRk
Conference talks (T4G / Mosaix / Verge / Exponential)	Third-party platforms	—	https://t4g.org/speakers/dhati-lewis/

Notes

Most of his video presence is the Where Life Exists / MyBLVD podcast content republished to YouTube, plus recorded conference sessions hosted on third-party platforms. View/subscriber metrics were not publicly retrievable as of 2026-06-04.

Content Audit

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/content-audit.md

Dhati Lewis: Content Audit

Executive Summary

Lewis's content is coherent in message (disciple-making, church-as-family, urban mission, racial reconciliation) but distributed across many surfaces: two B&H trade books and a LifeWay study, three hosted podcasts, several article archives, and conference teaching spread across T4G, Mosaix, Verge, and Exponential. There is no single canonical home that unifies the corpus.

Content Inventory Matrix

Format	Count / scope	Where it lives	State
Trade books	2 (Among Wolves 2017, Advocates 2019)	B&H / Amazon / retail	Well-distributed
Study resources	2 (Among Wolves Bible Study Book + Leader Kit)	LifeWay	Distributed
Self/network-published	1 (In Plain Sight, reported 2013)	Rebuild Network (no retail listing)	Fragmented / hard to find
Forewords	1 (Responsible Sibling)	Amazon	Distributed
Hosted podcasts	3 (Where Life Exists, MyBLVD, We Are Send Network)	Podbean, iHeart, Apple, YouTube	Split across platforms
Guest podcast appearances	2+ (Where Ya From?, The Gospel Culture & Me)	Third-party	Scattered
Articles	Multiple (ERLC, MyBLVD, Saturate, Outreach, Christian Post)	5+ outlets	Scattered; some archives blocked
Conference talks	Multiple	T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential, Moody Audio	Third-party hosted
Frameworks	4 named (Advocate/Aggravator, Eight Movements, Church as Family, 7 Stops)	Embedded in books/podcasts	Not consolidated as references

Content Architecture Observations

- The disciple-making corpus (Among Wolves + study + In Plain Sight + Where Life Exists) and the reconciliation corpus (Advocates + related talks) are two coherent clusters with no shared home.
- The named frameworks are load-bearing but live only inside long-form works; none has a canonical, linkable reference page.
- The podcast catalogue is the most fragmented asset — four hosting surfaces, no unified archive.

Factual Gaps

- In Plain Sight: no retail listing/ISBN.
- No Wikipedia page.
- No confirmed audiobook editions.
- No academic publications found.

Related Documentation

- [books.md](#) · [frameworks.md](#) · [audio.md](#) · [../summary.md](#) · [../fragmentation-story.md](#)

Academic Work

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/academic.md

Academic Publications: Dhati Lewis

Summary

No peer-reviewed academic publications, journal articles, or Google Scholar profile were found for Dhati Lewis as of 2026-06-04. His doctoral work is a Doctor of Ministry (a professional/practitioner degree), and his published output is trade and practitioner-oriented (B&H, LifeWay) rather than academic.

Academic Credentials

Credential	Institution	Notes
D.Min., Great Commission Mobilization	Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary	Professional doctorate; year ~2016–2017 (unconfirmed)
M.A., Cross-Cultural Ministry	Dallas Theological Seminary	—
B.A.	University of North Texas	Football scholarship

Sources: bhpublishinggroup.com, blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis.

Theses / Dissertations

No publicly available D.Min. thesis/project document was located.

Assessment

Lewis operates as a practitioner-author and church-planting executive, not an academic. His influence is through trade publishing, denominational leadership, and conference teaching rather than scholarly publication. No academic citations or Scholar profile found.

Courses & Training

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/content/courses.md

Courses & Training: Dhati Lewis

Study Curricula

Title	Format	Publisher	URL	Notes
Among Wolves — Bible Study Book	8-session small-group study	LifeWay (2017)	https://www.amazon.com/Among-Wolves-Bible-Disciple-Making/dp/1462742831	Disciple-making curriculum based on Among Wolves
Among Wolves — Leader Kit	Leader companion kit	LifeWay (2017)	https://www.amazon.com/Among-Wolves-Leader-Disciple-Making/dp/146274284X	Facilitation resources for the study

Training Networks & Programs

Program	Role	Notes
Send Network (NAMB)	Former VP → President	National church-planting training/residency infrastructure
Rebuild Network / Rebuild Initiative	Founder & President	Urban, multi-ethnic church-planting development
BLVD / MyBLVD	Founder & President	Mentoring/developing young urban-context leaders; "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" arc

Teaching Experience

Conference and platform teaching across Together for the Gospel (T4G), Mosaix, Verge, and Exponential (see [../digital-presence/platforms.md](#)). No standalone online course platform (e.g., a paid LMS) was found beyond the LifeWay study resources and the network-based residencies.

Notes

His "courses" are primarily the LifeWay Among Wolves study curriculum plus the church-planting residency/training delivered through Send Network and the Rebuild Initiative — formation through networks rather than packaged online courses.

Organizations & Affiliations

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/network/organizations.md

Organizational Network: Dhati Lewis

Organizations Founded / Led

Organization	Role	Years	Source
Blueprint Church (Atlanta)	Founding / lead (vision & multiplication) pastor; planted downtown with ~25 others	2009 (launched 2010) – present	blueprintchurch.org
Rebuild Initiative Inc. / Rebuild Network	Founder & President; network to plant multi-ethnic urban churches (parent of MyBLVD, Known 360)	~2011 – present	baptistpress.com
MyBLVD / BLVD ("Boulevard")	Founder & President; empowering disciple-makers in majority-minority communities	2021 – present	dhatilewis.com/about
North American Mission Board (NAMB) — Send Network	Vice President (Oct 2018) → President	2018 – end of 2021	baptistpress.com

Denominational & Network Affiliations

- **Southern Baptist Convention (SBC)** — via NAMB/Send Network leadership and Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary.
- **Send Institute** — author/contributor (sendinstitute.org).
- **National African American Fellowship (NAAF)** — Send Network-NAAF church-planting partnership (launched 2019).

Academic Affiliations

- University of North Texas (B.A.; football chaplain)
- Dallas Theological Seminary (M.A.)
- Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary (D.Min.)

Key Collaborators (Cross-Reference)

Person	Relationship	Source
Jeff Christopherson	Predecessor / mentor at Send Network	baptistpress.com
Kevin Ezell	NAMB President (oversight); endorser	baptistpress.com
Vance Pitman	Successor as Send Network president	namb.net
Larry Grays	Rebuild Initiative VP; pastor, Midtown Bridge Church	baptistpress.com
Greg Perkins	NAAF / Send Network-NAAF partnership	namb.net
Missie Branch	Co-host, MyBLVD Podcast	myblvdpodcast.podbean.com

Endorsers (of Advocates, 2019)

J.D. Greear, Derwin Gray, Kevin Ezell, Daniel Yang, Daniel Im, Michael "Stew" Stewart. Source: bhpublishinggroup.com.

Network Summary

Lewis sits at the intersection of three organizational worlds: his own Atlanta congregation (Blueprint), his urban church-planting network (Rebuild/MyBLVD), and the national SBC church-planting infrastructure (NAMB Send Network). His strongest edges are as a founder/leader of his own institutions and as a former national network executive; his endorsement and peer network clusters around the SBC multiethnic-church and church-multiplication ecosystem.

Confidence Assessment

High confidence on org roles and the six Advocates endorsers. Gaps: exact first year he joined NAMB/Send Network (pre-2018) and the precise VP→President transition date are unconfirmed; no verified Send Network church-plant count is attributable specifically to his tenure.

Audience & Reach

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/analysis/audience-analysis.md

Audience Analysis: Dhati Lewis

Estimated Reach

Signal	Value	Date	Source
Goodreads ratings — Advocates	4.07 avg, 175 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads ratings — Among Wolves	3.79 avg, 76 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads total	~256 ratings, ~40 reviews (all works)	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Instagram (@dhati.lewis)	~3,592 followers (search snapshot; unconfirmed)	2026-06-04	instagram.com/dhati.lewis
Twitter/X, Facebook, YouTube	counts not publicly visible	2026-06-04	—
Wikipedia	No dedicated page	2026-06-04	search

Audience Profile

Lewis's audience is primarily **pastors, church planters, and ministry practitioners** — especially those in urban, multiethnic, and majority-minority contexts — plus the broader Southern Baptist / evangelical church-planting ecosystem reached through NAMB, Send Network, and conferences (T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential). A secondary audience is readers engaged with **racial reconciliation** from a theologically conservative, Christ-centered frame.

Audience Personas

- **The urban church planter** — looking for a disciple-making model that works "among wolves" and a vision for staying in the city.
- **The multiethnic-church leader** — drawn to Advocates and the "narrow path" framing of reconciliation.
- **The SBC/evangelical practitioner** — encountering him through Send Network, conference platforms, and B&H/LifeWay resources.

What the Audience Values

Practical, framework-driven teaching grounded in Scripture and personal testimony; a both/and posture that holds theology and context together; and credibility as a practitioner who has actually planted and multiplied churches in the urban context.

Comparable Authors (reach / genre)

Author	Overlap
Derwin Gray	Multiethnic church; reconciliation; endorser of Advocates
Bryan Loritts	Urban/multiethnic ministry
Mark DeYmaz	Multiethnic church movement (Mosaix)
Daniel Im	Church multiplication / disciple-making

Engagement Patterns

Reach is concentrated in **owned long-form** (books, podcasts) and **borrowed platforms** (denominational sites, conference stages) more than in large personal social followings — his social numbers are modest relative to his institutional influence, indicating a practitioner/insider audience rather than a mass-market one.

Notes

Most social follower counts were not publicly retrievable; the Instagram figure is a search snapshot only. Reach is best understood through his institutional footprint (national network leadership, publisher-backed books) rather than social metrics.

Websites

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/digital-presence/websites.md

Web Properties: Dhati Lewis

Primary Website

Property	URL	Notes
Personal / author site	https://www.dhatilewis.com/	Tagline: "Teaching Christian Leaders to Navigate the Cultural Divide." Newsletter signup present; © 2021
Personal site — About	https://www.dhatilewis.com/about	Names him founder/president of Rebuild Initiative (MyBLVD Experience, MyBLVD Family, Known 360)
Where Life Exists (podcast hub)	https://www.dhatilewis.com/wherelifexists	Video podcast landing

Organizational Websites

Property	URL	Notes
Blueprint Church	https://www.blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis	Pastor bio
MyBLVD	https://myblvd.co/team/dhati-lewis/	"Vision and Multiplication Pastor of Blueprint Church; Founder and President of MyBLVD"
MyBLVD — author archive	https://myblvd.co/author/dhati/	His posts

Publisher & Retail Presence

Property	URL
Amazon author page	https://www.amazon.com/Dhati-Lewis/e/B06XTCGN2Z
B&H Publishing contributor	https://www.bhpublishinggroup.com/contributors/dhati-lewis/
Goodreads author	https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/7211235.Dhati_Lewis

Media & Content Contributor Presence

Property	URL
ERLC author	https://erlc.com/multi_author/dhati-lewis/
Saturate author	https://saturatetheworld.com/author/dhati/
New Churches contributor	https://www.newchurches.com/contributor/dhati-lewis/
Send Institute author	https://www.sendinstitute.org/author/dhati-lewis/
Moody Audio	https://moodyaudio.com/person/dhati-lewis

Notes

His web presence spans 5+ distinct domains (personal, church, initiative, publisher, contributor archives) with no single canonical hub unifying the body of work.

Publishing Platforms

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/digital-presence/platforms.md

Platform Presence: Dhati Lewis

Speaking & Conference Platforms

Platform	URL	Notes
Together for the Gospel (T4G)	https://t4g.org/speakers/dhati-lewis/	Speaker
Mosaix Conference	https://mosaixconference.com/speaker/dhati-lewis/	Speaker (multiethnic-church network)
Verge Network	https://vergenetwork.org/speakers/dhati-lewis/	Speaker
Exponential	https://exponential.org/person/dhati-lewis/	Speaker / contributor
ERLC	https://erlc.com/profile/dhati-lewis/	Contributor / event speaker
Authentic Manhood	https://www.authenticmanhood.com/the-team/dhati-lewis/	Team / contributor

Podcast Platforms

Platform	URL	Notes
Podbean	https://myblvdpodcast.podbean.com/	MyBLVD Podcast host
iHeart	https://www.iheart.com/podcast/338-myblvd-podcast-116978610/	MyBLVD Podcast
Apple Podcasts	https://podcasts.apple.com/bz/podcast/we-are-send-network/id1197627183	We Are Send Network
YouTube	https://www.youtube.com/@wherelifeexists	Where Life Exists / MyBLVD video

Learning / Content Platforms

Platform	URL	Notes
LifeWay	(see ../content/courses.md)	Among Wolves Bible study + leader kit
Send Network (NAMB)	https://www.namb.net/	Church-planting training/residency

Digital Presence Score: Dhati Lewis

Strong on **borrowed/institutional platforms** (denominational, conference, publisher) and weaker on **owned, consolidated** surfaces. Reach is mediated through trusted third-party platforms rather than a single owned hub.

Newsletters

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/digital-presence/newsletters.md

Newsletter & Email: Dhati Lewis

Newsletter

Property	URL	State
Personal site newsletter signup	https://www.dhatilewis.com/	A newsletter/email signup is present on his personal site. Cadence, list size, archive, and content are not publicly visible.

Notes

No public newsletter archive, subscriber count, or send cadence was found as of 2026-06-04. The only confirmed email-capture surface is the signup on [dhatilewis.com](https://www.dhatilewis.com/). MyBLVD and Blueprint Church may operate their own lists, but no public-facing newsletter archives were located.

Social Media

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/digital-presence/social-media.md

Social Media: Dhati Lewis

Account Summary

Platform	Handle	URL	Followers (2026-06-04)
Instagram	@dhati.lewis	https://www.instagram.com/dhati.lewis/	~3,592 (search snapshot; unconfirmed by direct fetch)
Twitter / X	@dhati	https://x.com/dhati	unknown (not visible)
Facebook	dhati.lewis ("Dhati Baraka Lewis")	https://www.facebook.com/dhati.lewis/	unknown
YouTube	@wherelifeexists	https://www.youtube.com/@wherelifeexists	unknown (channel stats not retrievable)
LinkedIn	—	not found	—
TikTok	—	not found	—

Platform Details

- **Instagram bio:** "Husband of one, Father of many, Lead Pastor of @blueprintchurch, Founder and President of @MyBLVDCo" — ~387 following, ~200 posts (search snapshot).
- **Facebook:** profile lists middle name "Baraka" (only source for the middle name).
- His personal site lists his platforms as YouTube, Twitter, Instagram, and Facebook only.

Notes

Follower/subscriber counts for X, Facebook, and YouTube were not publicly visible at research time; the Instagram figure (~3,592) comes from a search-engine snapshot rather than a direct fetch and should be treated as approximate. His social reach is modest relative to his institutional influence — consistent with a practitioner/insider audience.

The Fragmentation Story

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/fragmentation-story.md

Dhati Lewis: The Fragmentation Story

The Story

Dhati Lewis has built a coherent body of work — disciple-making in the city, the church as family, and a Christ-centered path to racial reconciliation — but that work does not live anywhere as one thing. It is scattered across two publishers, a self-published primer that has effectively disappeared, three podcasts on four different hosting platforms, a personal site, two organizational sites, half a dozen contributor archives, and years of conference talks held on other people's stages. A pastor looking for "the Dhati Lewis framework for disciple-making" has no single place to find it; they have to reassemble it from fragments.

Informational Fragmentation

Where his content actually lives:

- **Books** — Among Wolves and Advocates on B&H / Amazon / retail; the Among Wolves Bible study and leader kit on LifeWay; In Plain Sight (his 2013 primer) on no retail surface at all — reportedly a free e-book with no findable ISBN or product page. ([content/books.md](#))
- **Frameworks** — the Advocate/Aggravator triad, the Eight Movements in Matthew, "church as family," and the "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" are all load-bearing, but each lives buried inside a book or a podcast series. None has a canonical, linkable reference. ([content/frameworks.md](#))
- **Audio** — Where Life Exists on his site/YouTube, MyBLVD Podcast on Podbean and iHeart, We Are Send Network on Apple Podcasts. Three shows, four hubs, no unified archive. ([content/audio.md](#))
- **Articles** — pieces spread across ERLC, MyBLVD, Saturate, Outreach, and Christian Post; several archives are not even crawlable (HTTP 403), so the full catalogue is effectively invisible. ([content/articles.md](#))
- **Teaching** — conference sessions on T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential, and Moody Audio — all on borrowed platforms. ([digital-presence/platforms.md](#))
- **Web** — a personal site, Blueprint Church, MyBLVD, plus publisher and contributor pages: 5+ domains, no hub. ([digital-presence/websites.md](#))
- **In his head / undocumented** — the components of the "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" aren't fully written down anywhere public; the In Plain Sight material predates and underlies Among Wolves but is inaccessible.

Relational Fragmentation

His relational capital is real but dispersed: a national church-planting network he once led (Send Network), his own network (Rebuild/MyBLVD), a congregation (Blueprint), and a web of peers and endorsers (J.D. Greear, Derwin Gray, Kevin Ezell, Daniel Im, Daniel Yang, Michael Stewart, Larry Grays, Vance Pitman, Missie Branch). These relationships are visible only in scattered traces — an endorsement here, a co-hosted episode there, a succession announcement — never assembled into a single map of who he is connected to and how. ([network/organizations.md](#))

Synthesis

The problem is not coherence of message — Lewis is unusually consistent. The problem is **consolidation and discoverability**: the corpus is fragmented across surfaces he doesn't own, the named frameworks have no canonical home, the podcast catalogue is split four ways, and an entire early work has fallen off the map. The disciple-making vision that animates everything he does is, ironically, hard to disciple-make from, because no one place holds it.

Research Provenance

Generated 2026-06-04 by the `movement-leader-substrate` cold-start research for `dhati-lewis`, from the cited sources in [sources.md](#). Factual inventory only — no marketing analysis or opportunity scoring (those belong to separate consulting artifacts).

A Letter — Reflected Understanding

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/reflected-understanding/dhati-lewis.md`

A Letter to Dhati Lewis

Dhati — this is our attempt to reflect back what we understand about your calling and your work, in your own terms, before we ever talk about building anything. If we've misread you, the gaps are ours to fix.

Calling

You are called to make disciples who make disciples in the city — and to keep the church in the city rather than fleeing it. From the beginning you've insisted that disciple-making, not church-planting, is the engine: plant a church and you're not guaranteed disciples, but make disciples and a church — a family — is the logical result. You founded Blueprint Church in Atlanta in 2009 on exactly that conviction, and you've said you want it to be part of "the last generation to [have to] leave the urban context for sound discipleship."

That calling has worn several institutional shapes. You built the Rebuild Network to plant multi-ethnic urban churches. You led the North American Mission Board's Send Network — as Vice President and then President — and used that seat to diversify who gets to plant, including the partnership with the National African American Fellowship. And then you stepped out of that national seat, at the end of 2021, to do the more particular work: developing and mentoring young leaders who will plant in the urban context, through BLVD and MyBLVD. The through-line is unmistakable — disciple-making and church-as-family, carried into the multiethnic city, and now poured into the next generation.

Your reconciliation work is part of the same calling, not a separate one. In *Advocates* you argued that Christians must become advocates rather than aggravators — relying on Christ, running to the tension, responding with dignity — a Christ-centered "narrow path" distinct from politically-driven division. It's the same posture as your disciple-making: refuse the easy binary, run toward the hard thing, stay.

Existing Content (before the platform we're building)

You've already made a great deal. There are the books — *Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City* (2017), built on eight movements through Matthew, with a LifeWay Bible study and leader kit; *Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation* (2019), built on Philemon; and the earlier primer *In Plain Sight*, which seeded *Among Wolves*. There are the podcasts you host — *Where Life Exists*, the *MyBLVD Podcast* with Missie Branch and its "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary," and *We Are Send Network*. There are articles across ERLC, Saturate, Outreach,

and the Christian Post, and years of teaching from the stages of Together for the Gospel, Mosaix, Verge, and Exponential. And there are the frameworks people quote you for: Advocate-versus-Aggravator, the eight movements, the church as family, the seven stops.

The honest observation is that this body of work doesn't live anywhere as one thing. The books are at two publishers; In Plain Sight has effectively disappeared; the podcasts are split across four platforms; the frameworks live buried inside long-form works rather than standing as references. The message is coherent. The surface is scattered.

Constraints

We want to name the constraints as we understand them, because they shape what's worth building. First, your instinct is to run to people, not to build infrastructure that sits between you and them — you've warned that overhead can mean "a lot of overhead and little impact," and that gifts can take a person where their character can't follow. Anything built around your work has to serve presence, not replace it. Second, you operate as a practitioner and a pastor, not an academic or a brand — your reach is through trusted networks and stages more than through a large personal platform, and that's a feature of the calling, not a deficit. Third, the work is unfinished in a specific way: some of it — most notably the "7 Stops" — isn't fully written down anywhere, and an early foundational piece is no longer findable.

If we've understood you, the question worth asking together is simply this: could the work be gathered — frameworks, catalogue, the pieces still in your head — so that the next urban missionary doesn't have to leave to find sound discipleship? That's your sentence, not ours. We just want to help make it true.

— The Movemental team

Welcome Letter

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/welcome-letter.md`

Dhati,

We've spent real time with your work — not skimming it, but reading it the way you'd want a fellow practitioner to: Among Wolves with its eight movements through Matthew, Advocates and its narrow path through Philemon, the Where Life Exists conversations, the "Why I Stay" series, the Saturate essay where you insisted the church "is not like family; it is family." What follows isn't a pitch. It's what we saw, and what we think it would take to put it all in one place.

The first thing we noticed is how consistent you are. Most leaders drift; you don't. From In Plain Sight in 2013 to Among Wolves in 2017 to the urban-missionary work of MyBLVD now, it's one conviction worked out over a decade: disciple-making, not church-planting, is the engine — "if you make disciples the logical result is a church." You've said you want Blueprint to be part of "the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship." That line is a thesis, and almost everything you've made is a footnote to it.

The second thing we noticed is that your work doesn't live anywhere as one thing. Among Wolves is at B&H; the Bible study and leader kit are at LifeWay; In Plain Sight — the seed of all of it — has no retail page at all, no ISBN we could find, effectively gone. Where Life Exists is on your site and YouTube; the MyBLVD Podcast with Missie Branch is on Podbean and iHeart; We Are Send Network is on Apple. Your articles are scattered across ERLC, Saturate, Outreach, and Christian Post — and some of those archives won't even load for a search engine. A pastor in a hard city who wants "the Dhati Lewis way to make disciples among wolves" has to assemble you from fragments.

The third thing: your frameworks are doing the heavy lifting, and not one of them has a home. The Advocate-versus-Aggravator triad — rely on Christ, run to the tension, respond with dignity. The eight movements in Matthew. The church as family. The "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" — which, as far as we can tell, isn't fully written down anywhere public at all. These are the things people quote you for, and they live buried inside long-form works instead of standing as references someone can find, link, and build on.

So here's what we'd do. We'd give the whole corpus one searchable home — the books, the studies, the podcast catalogue pulled together from its four platforms, the articles rescued from archives that don't crawl — and we'd make the frameworks first-class: each one a page a planter in Atlanta or Memphis or anywhere "life exists" can actually find. We'd capture the "7 Stops" out of your head and the podcast and into something durable. The goal isn't more content; you have enough. The goal is that the disciple-making vision you've spent a decade on becomes something others can disciple-make from.

We'd also hold your relational world in one place — not to commodify it, but because it's part of the story. The network you led at Send, the one you're building at MyBLVD, the peers who vouch for the work: that map matters, and right now it only exists in scattered traces.

We know the tension here, because it's your own tension — you'd rather run to the people than build infrastructure that sits between you and them. You've warned that gifts can take us where our character can't handle, and that overhead can mean "a lot of overhead and little impact." We're not asking you to become an institution. We're asking whether the work could be gathered so the next urban missionary doesn't have to leave to find sound discipleship — which is, after all, the thing you said you wanted.

If that's worth a conversation, we're ready when you are.

— The Movemental team

Welcome Letter 2026 06 09

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/welcome-letter-2026-06-09.md`

Dhati

You have built one of the most coherent disciple-making bodies of work in the American urban church. Among Wolves in 2017, its companion Bible study and leader kit, Advocates in 2019, the In Plain Sight primer in 2013 — and underneath them, fifteen years of practice: Blueprint Church, founded in Atlanta in 2009; the Rebuild Initiative you launched and lead; three years carrying the North American Mission Board's Send Network from Vice President to President. Today you are Vision and Multiplication Pastor at Blueprint and founder and president of MyBLVD. That last role matters most for what follows.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. Among Wolves sits at B&H and on Amazon; the Bible study and leader kit are at LifeWay; In Plain Sight, the seed of everything after, has no ISBN and no product page — it has effectively fallen off the map. Your audio is split four ways: Where Life Exists on your own site and YouTube, the MyBLVD Podcast you co-host with Missie Branch on Podbean and iHeart, We Are Send Network on Apple. Three shows, four hubs, no single archive. Your essays scatter across ERLC, Saturate, Outreach, and Christian Post — and several of those archives won't load for a search engine, so the catalogue is invisible. The teaching is worse off, because it lives on other people's stages: T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential, Moody Audio. The relational layer fragments the same way. The planters you raised at Send Network live in NAMB's systems; the leaders you form now live in the MyBLVD roster; the congregation lives at Blueprint; and the people who vouch for the work — J.D. Greear, Derwin Gray, Daniel Im, Vance Pitman, Missie Branch — exist only as scattered endorsements and co-hosted episodes, alongside the far larger rolodex in your phone and memory. What is missing is the layer above all of it: the one place that lets a reader move from any single piece to every other, and lets people stay with you after they leave the network that introduced them.

The largest pool of value you have is also the one most likely to go unwritten. The "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary," as far as anyone outside your own rooms can tell, is not written down anywhere public; it lives in your head and in the cohorts you walk through it. So does the reasoning behind the Advocate-and-Aggravator triad, the eight movements you trace through Matthew, and the decision — made and re-made for fifteen years — to keep a church planted in the urban context instead of following the exodus out. The case studies behind Blueprint, the judgment calls behind leading a national network and then handing it on, the same conversation you have had a thousand times with a young planter in a hard neighborhood: none of it is anywhere a stranger can find.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory you just read — the books traced across B&H and LifeWay and the gap where In Plain Sight should be, the podcast catalogue mapped across four platforms, the essays located in archives that won't crawl — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the weeks it would take a

human researcher to do the same. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: interview transcripts that capture the "7 Stops" in your own words, course-note extraction, dictation that becomes a draft and a draft that becomes an essay — the embodied layer surfaced at your pace rather than a publisher's. The AI does not replace your voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. The authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate: pull the books and the Bible study, the In Plain Sight material, the three podcasts, the ERLC and Saturate essays, the conference sessions, and the frameworks as they surface into one searchable home. Second, interconnect: trace the real chains, so Among Wolves points to the eight movements in Matthew, which point to the Where Life Exists episodes that work them out, which point to the Saturate essay where you insisted the church "is not like family; it is family," which points back to the disciple-making argument the whole thing rests on. Third, repurpose: the "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" becomes a public sequence instead of an oral tradition; the MyBLVD Podcast back-catalogue becomes a searchable teaching archive; In Plain Sight gets a real home and a pathway built around it; the conference talks become an archive under your own name. Fourth, amplify: the SEO and network effects that arrive once the frameworks are findable in one place, so the references point back to you. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, dhatilewis.com looks different. It is no longer a landing page with a dormant newsletter signup; it is the front door to the whole body of work. A disciple-making hub gathers Among Wolves, its Bible study, the urban-missionary pathway, the Where Life Exists and MyBLVD episodes, and a list people can actually join. In Plain Sight is archived and readable under your name for the first time in years. The eight movements and the Advocate-and-Aggravator triad stand as linkable references instead of pages buried in a book. And a church planter in Memphis who has never heard of Send Network or Rebuild searches how to make disciples in the city, finds the Among Wolves pathway on a Tuesday morning, and starts working through it that afternoon.

This is your next season. The work ahead is not another book; it is making the disciple-making vision you have already built reach the planters it was written for. Being Blueprint's Vision and Multiplication Pastor and the president of MyBLVD does not compete with that work — it is the reason it has to happen now, because the next generation of urban missionaries you are mentoring cannot yet find, in one place, the body of work you would hand them. Right now they cannot.

— Movemental

Research Collated (Substrate)

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/DHATI_LEWIS_RESEARCH_COLLATED.md`

Dhati Lewis — Movement Leader Research (Substrate)

Slug: `dhati-lewis`

Version: 2.0.0 (substrate)

Last updated: 2026-06-04

Purpose: Machine-readable corpus for identity resolution, relational traversal, conceptual indexing, and voice fidelity. Not a consulting report.

1. Identity

Field	Value	Source
Full legal name	Dhati Lewis (middle name "Baraka" appears on his personal Facebook as "Dhati Baraka Lewis" — self-published, probable not authoritative)	facebook.com/dhati.lewis
Known as	Dhati Lewis	dhatilewis.com/about
Born	unknown (no published birth date or year)	—
Birthplace	Born and raised in California	plantmidwest.com
Childhood	Raised in California; son of an NFL player (father's name not published); recruited to play football at the University of North Texas	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis , plantmidwest.com
Current location	Atlanta, Georgia	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Nationality	American	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Heritage	Black / African American (self-described "a black pastor serving in an urban church")	Among Wolves (Amazon)
Primary roles	Founding/lead pastor, Blueprint Church (Atlanta); Founder & President, Rebuild Initiative Inc. / MyBLVD; former Vice President → President, Send Network (NAMB)	dhatilewis.com/about , myblvd.co
Primary organizations	Blueprint Church; Rebuild Initiative Inc. (MyBLVD Experience, MyBLVD Family, Known 360); North American Mission Board / Send Network (former)	dhatilewis.com/about
US sponsor (if applicable)	n/a (US-based)	—
Spouse / partner	Angie (Angela) Lewis	blueprintchurch.org/angela-lewis
Education	B.A., University of North Texas; M.A. in Cross-Cultural Ministry, Dallas Theological Seminary; D.Min. in Great Commission Mobilization, Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary (degree years unknown)	bhpublishinggroup.com , blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Children	Six named — Trinity, Jade, Briaiah, Dhati, Brayden, Nathaniel (one Blueprint bio says "seven"; six is best-supported)	authenticmanhood.com
Coined term (if applicable)	None verified. Signature phrase: vision to be "the last generation to [have to] leave the urban context for sound discipleship"	namb.net

2. Disambiguation

1 dominant public figure named Dhati Lewis — **subject is the pastor only**. "Dhati" is a rare given name, so cross-contamination is low.

#	Identity	Disambiguate with	Exclude
1	Dhati Lewis — pastor, church planter, author (Blueprint Church / Send Network)	"Blueprint Church", "Send Network", "Among Wolves", "Advocates"	—
2	"Dhati Lewis" college-football entry on Sports-Reference (page returned 403; could not verify) — may be the same person , given the pastor played football at UNT	"cfb", "college football stats"	confirm against ministry sources before merging

Reliable modifiers: Blueprint Church, Send Network / NAMB, Among Wolves, Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation, MyBLVD / Rebuild Initiative — these uniquely retrieve the subject. Distinct, unrelated names that surface in search (D.D. Lewis, Damione Lewis — NFL players) are NOT him.

3. Editorial bio

Dhati Lewis was born and raised in California, the son of an NFL player, and came to Texas on a football scholarship to the University of North Texas. Out of his collegiate years — chaplaincy to the UNT football team and early college ministry — came a vocation toward urban disciple-making, formalized through a Master's in Cross-Cultural Ministry at Dallas Theological Seminary and later a Doctor of Ministry in Great Commission Mobilization at Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary.

In 2009 he and roughly twenty-five others relocated to downtown Atlanta to found Blueprint Church, built on a conviction that the church "is not like family; it is family" and that disciple-making — not church-planting — is the engine of multiplication. He launched the Rebuild Network in 2011 to plant multi-ethnic churches in urban contexts, and articulated his disciple-making theology in *Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City* (B&H, 2017) and his approach to racial reconciliation in *Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation* (B&H, 2019).

From 2018 he led the North American Mission Board's Send Network — voted Vice President in October 2018 and later serving as President — before departing at the end of 2021 to focus on Blueprint and a new initiative, BLVD/MyBLVD, under the Rebuild Initiative, aimed at empowering disciple-makers in majority-minority, multiethnic communities. He hosts the *Where Life Exists* and *MyBLVD* podcasts and teaches widely across the church-planting ecosystem (T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential).

4. Timeline

Year(s)	Milestone	Organization / work	Source
(childhood)	Born and raised in California, son of an NFL player	—	plantmidwest.com
~early 1990s	Football scholarship to University of North Texas; later football chaplain, college pastor, planted a church in Texas	University of North Texas	blueprintchurch.org/dhatilewis
(grad school)	M.A. in Cross-Cultural Ministry	Dallas Theological Seminary	bhpublishinggroup.com
2009	Moved to Atlanta with ~25 others; founded Blueprint Church (launched downtown 2010)	Blueprint Church	blueprintchurch.org/dhatilewis , baptistpress.com
2011	Launched the Rebuild Network (urban church planting); NAMB partnership	Rebuild Network / NAMB	baptistpress.com
2013	In Plain Sight: A Primer for Reclaiming Discipleship in the Local Church (reported; unconfirmed)	Rebuild Network	Goodreads author page
~2016–2017	D.Min. in Great Commission Mobilization (described as "most recently received" in 2017)	Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary	bhpublishinggroup.com
2017	Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City + Bible Study Book + Leader Kit	B&H / LifeWay	bhpublishinggroup.com
Oct 2, 2018	Voted Vice President of Send Network by NAMB trustees (succeeding Jeff Christopherson)	NAMB / Send Network	baptistpress.com
2019	Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation; launched Send Network–NAAF diversity partnership	B&H / Send Network	baptistpress.com , namb.net
~2019–2021	Served as President of Send Network (~3 years leading the network)	Send Network	namb.net
End of 2021	Departed NAMB to launch BLVD/ MyBLVD; succeeded as Send Network president by Vance Pitman	Rebuild Initiative / NAMB	namb.net
2022–	Continues as Blueprint lead/vision pastor + Founder & President, Rebuild Initiative (MyBLVD, Known 360)	Blueprint / Rebuild Initiative	dhatilewis.com/about

5. Frameworks

Advocate vs. Aggravator

Field	Value
Introduced	2019, Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation
Components	(1) Rely on Christ; (2) Run to the tension; (3) Respond with dignity
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Framing for Advocates (B&H, 2019); used in his reconciliation teaching and conference talks
Source	baptistpress.com

An "advocate" pursues reconciliation by relying on Christ, running toward (not away from) racial tension, and responding with dignity; an "aggravator" deepens division out of self-interest, self-preservation, or self-vindication. The schema is drawn exegetically from Paul's letter to Philemon.

Eight Movements in Matthew (disciple-making model)

Field	Value
Introduced	2017, Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City
Components	Eight "movements" traced through Matthew's Gospel, from Jesus establishing His presence with His followers to mobilizing them to make disciples of all nations
Visual / model	Structured around Matthew's narrative arc
Adoption evidence	Basis of Among Wolves book + 8-session LifeWay Bible study + Leader Kit
Source	bhpublishinggroup.com

A disciple-making culture built by following eight movements in Matthew that turn passive church participants into active disciple-makers in the city.

Church as Family (ecclesiology)

Field	Value
Introduced	Developed in Among Wolves (2017); articulated in his Saturate essay (2017)
Components	Identity precedes activity; establish belonging/family before infrastructure; "if you make disciples the logical result is a church"
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Blueprint Church's discipleship strategy: "develop healthy people who are growing in the Gospel, in the context of family, while living on mission"
Source	saturatetheworld.com

"The church is not like family; it is family." Disciple-making, not church-planting, is the engine: plant a church and you are not guaranteed disciples, but make disciples and a church (family) is the logical result.

The 7 Steps of an Urban Missionary

Field	Value
Introduced	MyBLVD Podcast (with Missie Branch)
Components	A seven-stop sequence framing the formation of an "urban missionary" (individual stops not fully catalogued in sources reached)
Visual / model	Podcast series arc
Adoption evidence	MyBLVD Podcast / Rebuild Initiative content
Source	myblvdpodcast.podbean.com

A named teaching arc on MyBLVD that sequences the journey of an "urban missionary."
(Component detail not fully documented — see Open questions.)

6. Bibliography

Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Key themes	One sentence	URL
Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation	Dhati Lewis	B&H Books	2019	9781535934671 (hc); 9781535934688 (ebook)	racial reconciliation, advocacy, Philemon, heart posture	Using Paul's letter to Philemon, Lewis argues Christians must become advocates — not aggravators — pursuing reconciliation by relying on Christ, running to the tension, and responding with dignity.	Amazon
Among Wolves — Leader Kit: Disciple Making in the City	Dhati Lewis	LifeWay	2017	9781462742844	disciple-making, small-group teaching	Leader companion kit to the Among Wolves Bible study.	Amazon
Among Wolves — Bible Study Book: Disciple Making in the City	Dhati Lewis	LifeWay	2017	9781462742837	disciple-making, urban ministry	8-session Bible study companion to Among Wolves.	Amazon
Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City	Dhati Lewis	B&H Books	2017	9781433644023	disciple-making, the city, church as family, mobilization	Walking through eight movements in Matthew, Lewis equips leaders to build a disciple-making culture that turns passive participants into active	B&H

Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Key themes	One sentence	URL
						disciple-makers in the city.	
In Plain Sight: A Primer for Reclaiming Discipleship in the Local Church	Dhati Lewis	Rebuild Network (reported)	2013 (reported)	unknown	reclaiming discipleship, local-church disciple-making	Precursor to Among Wolves; a primer on reclaiming local-church discipleship (reportedly a free e-book).	Goodreads

Summary: 5 entries (4 unique works + 1 study/leader-kit pair); all solo-authored; publishers B&H and LifeWay (2017) plus a reported 2013 Rebuild Network primer; ~256 Goodreads ratings across all works (Advocates 4.07/175; Among Wolves 3.79/76; In Plain Sight 4.50/2). Lewis also wrote the **foreword** to Responsible Sibling by Jorge Mendoza (ISBN-13 9781546499428) — not an authored title. Sources: [Goodreads author page](#), [bhpublishinggroup.com](#).

Theme map

Theme	Primary works
Disciple-making	Among Wolves (+ Bible study/leader kit), In Plain Sight
The city / urban ministry	Among Wolves
Church as family	Among Wolves; Saturate essay; foreword to Responsible Sibling
Racial reconciliation	Advocates
Multiethnic church / leadership across the cultural divide	Advocates; positioning/bio
Church planting & multiplication	Send Network role; Among Wolves

Content analysis (structured)

Tier	Theme	Description	Key works	Centrality (1-10)
Primary	Disciple-making in the urban context	Disciple-making (not church-planting) as the engine of multiplication, centered on the city	Among Wolves, In Plain Sight	10
Primary	Church as family	Ecclesiology in which the church is family; identity/belonging precede activity	Among Wolves, Saturate essay	8
Secondary	Racial reconciliation	A Christ-centered "narrow path" of advocacy over political aggravation	Advocates	8
Secondary	Multiethnic / cross-cultural leadership	Equipping leaders to "navigate the cultural divide"	Advocates, bio/positioning	6
Emerging	Urban missionary formation	Forming "urban missionaries" via MyBLVD	MyBLVD Podcast, BLVD initiative	5

Recommended reading order

Order	Work	Rationale
1	Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City	The core thesis — disciple-making and church-as-family — that frames everything else.
2	Among Wolves — Bible Study Book	Applies the eight-movements model in a group/practitioner format.
3	Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation	Extends the disciple-making vision into reconciliation and the multiethnic church.
4	In Plain Sight	Early primer; read last as the seed-form precursor to Among Wolves.

7. Voice fingerprint

Weighted markers (must sum to 100%)

Marker	Target	Weight
Triadic, framework-driven structure (memorable three-part schemes)	≥ 0.7	30%
Exegetical anchoring (whole book built on one biblical book; chapter-and-verse inline)	≥ 0.7	25%
Narrative / personal testimony framing	0.5–0.8	20%
Direct second-person address to practitioners	0.5–0.8	15%
"Run to the tension" both/and move (holds binaries rather than resolving them)	≥ 0.6	10%
Coherence target	≥ 0.75	—

Hallmark lexicon (9+ terms)

disciple-making, disciple-makers, the city / urban context, urban missionary, run to the tension, advocate / ministry of reconciliation, respond with dignity, rely on Christ, the church as family, navigate the cultural divide, holistic disciple-makers, the last generation to leave the urban context

Antithesis prohibition (non-negotiable)

Do not collapse Lewis's deliberately-held both/and tensions into a one-sided "not X but Y" resolution. His signature move is to name a binary — context vs. theology, comfort vs. obedience, fleeing vs. staying — and then refuse to choose a side, calling the listener to "run to the tension" rather than past it. Writing in his voice that dissolves a tension by picking the "correct" pole misreads him; he holds the tension as the doorway to mission. Derived from his Where Ya From? Ep. 56 framing ("either I was around people who got my context but didn't have that same commitment to theology and mission, or... they didn't get my context").

Source: whereyafrom.org.

Representative quotes (5+)

"We need to be careful with ministry because sometimes our gifts will take us to places that our character can't handle." — Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City ([Goodreads](#))

"Cities are not only diverse culturally, but also socioeconomically. In urban settings, in a one-mile area, one can see extreme poverty intertwined with extreme wealth..." — Among Wolves ([Goodreads](#))

"Racial division is a real problem that demands real solutions that can lead to real transformation." — NAMB feature on Advocates ([namb.net](#))

"For us to become advocates, we must do the hard work of facing anything that defines us that is divisive and not of Christ." — NAMB feature on Advocates (namb.net)

"And many of us define God's will by the path of least resistance... our North Stars are comfort, and we're addicted to our comfort." — Where Ya From? Ep. 56, 2023-10-17 (whereyafrom.org)

"We wanted to establish a blueprint... a church that's planting other churches because we want to be a church that's going to be the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship." — Where Ya From? Ep. 56 (whereyafrom.org)

8. Theological positioning

Domain	Position
Tradition	Southern Baptist (SBC); trained at Dallas Theological Seminary and Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary. No explicit "Reformed" self-identification found.
Ecclesiology	Church-as-family over church-as-institution; identity/belonging precede activity; critiques building organizational infrastructure before authentic community
Missiology	Urban disciple-making and multiplication; "a healthy, multiplying church in every community"; equipping urban and majority-minority leaders
Leadership	Mobilize passive participants into active, "holistic" disciple-makers; teach leaders to "navigate the cultural divide"
Christology	Christ-centered reconciliation; "rely on Christ" as the first mark of an advocate (not separately systematized in sources)
Anthropology / formation	Disciple-making forms the person in the context of family and mission; character must keep pace with gifting
Culture	Racial reconciliation as a Christ-centered "narrow path"; heart posture over political positioning; shared responsibility for reconciliation

Distinctive claims (bulleted)

- Disciple-making — not church-planting — is the engine: "if you make disciples the logical result is a church/family." (saturatetheworld.com)
- The church is literally family, not merely like family. (saturatetheworld.com)
- Reconciliation is a Christ-centered "narrow path" of advocacy, distinguished from politically-driven "aggravation." (baptistpress.com)
- Vision to be "the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship." (namb.net)

9. Intellectual genealogy

Upstream influences

Person	Ideas adopted	Source
Jeff Christopherson	Send Network missiology / church-planting strategy (predecessor and leader Lewis served under)	baptistpress.com
Kevin Ezell (NAMB President)	NAMB "Send North America" strategy; champion of the NAMB-Rebuild partnership	baptistpress.com

Named theological/authorial mentors are not documented in sources reached; his training pedigree (Dallas Theological Seminary, Southeastern) situates him in conservative evangelical / SBC streams. (See Open questions.)

Downstream impact (documented)

Channel	Evidence
Rebuild Network / Initiative	Founded 2011 to plant multi-ethnic urban churches; partnered with NAMB's Send North America strategy (baptistpress.com)
Send Network leadership	Drove ethnic diversity among church planters; launched the Send Network-NAAF partnership (2019; first NAAF-sourced residents assessed Nov 2021) (namb.net)
BLVD / MyBLVD	Departed NAMB to "develop and mentor young leaders who will plant churches in the urban context" (namb.net)

Caveat: no reliable Send Network church-plant count is attributable specifically to Lewis's tenure (the 70+/300+ figures in the succession coverage belong to Vance Pitman's Hope Church, not Lewis).

Peer dialogue

Person	Relationship	Shared themes
Larry Grays	Rebuild Initiative VP; pastor, Midtown Bridge Church (Atlanta)	Urban church planting
Vance Pitman	Successor as Send Network president; publicly endorsed by Lewis	Church planting / multiplication
Greg Perkins	NAAF / Send Network-NAAF partnership	Ethnic diversity in church planting
Missie Branch	Co-host, MyBLVD Podcast	Urban missionary formation
Daniel Yang / Daniel Im / Michael "Stew" Stewart	Church-planting ecosystem peers (Send Institute / NewChurches / Verge); endorsed Advocates	Church multiplication

Constructive tensions (documented)

No documented constructive tensions from neutral, reliable sources. (Advocacy-framed critiques of his racial-reconciliation emphasis exist within intra-SBC "anti-woke" channels; not used here as factual sources.)

Comparable authors (reach / genre, not affinity scores)

Author	Overlap
Derwin Gray	Multiethnic church; reconciliation; endorser of Advocates
Bryan Loritts	Urban/multiethnic ministry; Where Life Exists guest
Mark DeYmaz	Multiethnic church movement (Mosaix network)
Daniel Im	Church multiplication / disciple-making resources

10. Network graph

Co-authors

Person	Joint works	Edge weight	Notes
—	—	—	No co-authored books; all titles sole-authored. Foreword for Jorge Mendoza's Responsible Sibling (collaboration, not co-authorship).

Endorsements received (sample)

From	For	Year	URL / note
J.D. Greear	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Derwin Gray	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Kevin Ezell	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Daniel Yang	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Daniel Im	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Michael "Stew" Stewart	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com

Organizational affiliations

- **Blueprint Church** (Atlanta) — founding / lead (vision & multiplication) pastor, 2009–present
- **Rebuild Initiative Inc. / Rebuild Network** — founder & president, ~2011–present (parent of MyBLVD Experience, MyBLVD Family, Known 360)
- **MyBLVD / BLVD ("Boulevard")** — founder & president, 2021–present

- **North American Mission Board / Send Network** — VP (Oct 2018) → President, until end of 2021
- **Send Institute** — author/contributor
- **University of North Texas** (B.A.; football chaplain); **Dallas Theological Seminary** (M.A.); **Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary** (D.Min.)

JSON graph (nodes + edges)

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11. Reach metrics

Signal	Value	Date	Source
Goodreads ratings — Advocates	4.07 avg, 175 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads ratings — Among Wolves	3.79 avg, 76 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads ratings — In Plain Sight	4.50 avg, 2 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads total	~256 ratings, ~40 reviews (all works)	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads author followers	4	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Instagram followers (@dhati.lewis)	~3,592 (search snapshot; unconfirmed by direct fetch)	2026-06-04	instagram.com/dhati.lewis
Twitter/X followers (@dhati)	unknown	2026-06-04	x.com/dhati
YouTube subscribers (@wherelifeexists)	unknown	2026-06-04	youtube.com/@wherelifeexists
Podcasts hosted	3 (Where Life Exists, MyBLVD, We Are Send Network)	2026-06-04	see Distribution inventory
Verified guest appearances	2+ (Where Ya From?; The Gospel, Culture & Me)	2026-06-04	whereyafrom.org
Wikipedia presence	None found	2026-06-04	search

12. Distribution inventory

Books: Advocates (B&H, 2019); Among Wolves + Bible Study Book + Leader Kit (B&H/LifeWay, 2017); In Plain Sight (Rebuild Network, reported 2013); foreword to Responsible Sibling (Jorge Mendoza). See §6.

Articles & blogs: ERLC author archive (erlc.com); MyBLVD (myblvd.co/author/dhati); Saturate (saturatetheworld.com/author/dhati); Outreach Magazine voices/feature; Christian Post interview (christianpost.com).

Audio: Podcasts hosted — Where Life Exists (dhatilewis.com/wherelifeexists), MyBLVD Podcast (with Missie Branch; myblvdpodcast.podbean.com), We Are Send Network (with Noah Oldham & Heiden Ratner). Guest: Where Ya From? Ep. 56 (Christianity Today, 2023); The Gospel, Culture & Me Ep. 16. Recorded teaching on Moody Audio.

Video: YouTube @wherelifeexists ([youtube.com/@wherelifeexists](https://www.youtube.com/@wherelifeexists)); MyBLVD episodes on YouTube.

Courses & assessments: Among Wolves 8-session Bible study + Leader Kit (LifeWay, 2017).

Websites & orgs: dhatilewis.com, blueprintchurch.org, myblvd.co; author pages at [Amazon](#), [B&H](#), [Goodreads](#); speaker pages at [T4G](#), [Mosaix](#), [Verge](#), [Exponential](#).

Social: Instagram [@dhati.lewis](#); Twitter/X [@dhati](#); Facebook [dhati.lewis](#); YouTube [@wherelifeexists](#).

Academic / papers: None found.

Translations: None found.

Content gap table (factual state only)

Asset	State	Source
In Plain Sight (2013)	No retail ISBN or publisher page located; reportedly a free e-book	Goodreads
Wikipedia	No dedicated page exists	search 2026-06-04
Audiobook editions	Not confirmed for any title	—
Academic publications	None found	—

13. Sources (provenance)

URL	Verifies
https://www.dhatilewis.com/about	Roles, Rebuild Initiative/MyBLVD, current positioning
https://www.blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis	Bio, Blueprint founding (2009), education, upbringing
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/trustees-record-aaeo-new-vps-top-namb-agenda/	Send Network VP appointment (Oct 2, 2018)
https://www.namb.net/news/send-networks-dhati-lewis-leaving-namb-for-new-project/	President title, NAAF partnership, departure end of 2021
https://www.namb.net/news/vance-pitman-to-lead-nambs-send-network/	Succession by Vance Pitman; ~3-year tenure
https://www.bhpublishinggroup.com/product/among-wolves-2/	Among Wolves details, education (DTS, Southeastern)
https://www.amazon.com/Advocates-Narrow-Path-Racial-Reconciliation/dp/1535934670	Advocates details
https://www.bhpublishinggroup.com/product/advocates-2/advocates-2/	Advocates endorsers
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/path-to-reconciliation-focus-of-advocates/	Advocate/aggravator framework
https://saturatetheworld.com/2017/07/20/dont-just-start-church-establish-family/	Church-as-family ecclesiology
https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/7211235.Dhati_Lewis	Bibliography, ratings, reach metrics
https://whereyafrom.org/episode/episode-56-a-blueprint-for-discipleship-in-an-urban-context-with-dhati-lewis/	Verbatim quotes, voice
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/urban-engagement-sparks-namb-rebuild-partnership/	Rebuild Network (2011), Larry Grays, Kevin Ezell

Digital-presence file pointers (for traceability): This substrate was assembled from cold-start web research (no on-disk per-topic source files existed at generation time). Per-topic files under `profile/`, `content/`, `network/`, `analysis/`, `digital-presence/` may be authored later; this document is the consolidated read surface.

14. Open questions

- Date / year of birth — unknown.
- Father's name (the NFL player) — unknown.
- Exact graduation years for B.A., M.A., and D.Min. (D.Min. likely ~2016–2017) — unknown.
- Number of children — sources conflict (six named vs. "seven"); six is best-supported.

- Middle name "Baraka" — only from his own Facebook; not in any institutional bio.
- Exact date he transitioned from VP to President of Send Network — unknown.
- Verified Send Network church-plant count attributable to his tenure — not found.
- Among Wolves endorsers — could not be retrieved (publisher/retail pages did not list blurbs).
- In Plain Sight — ISBN, publisher, and 2013 year unconfirmed by any retail/publisher page.
- Components of "The 7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" — not fully catalogued in sources reached.
- Whether the Sports-Reference college-football "Dhati Lewis" is the same person — unconfirmed (page blocked).
- Social follower/subscriber counts for Twitter/X, Facebook, YouTube — not visible; Instagram (~3,592) from a search snapshot only.

Sources

docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/sources.md

Sources: Dhati Lewis

Provenance for the Dhati Lewis research tree. Assembled from cold-start web research on 2026-06-04.

Primary / institutional

URL	Verifies
https://www.dhatilewis.com/about	Roles, Rebuild Initiative/MyBLVD, positioning
https://www.blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis	Bio, Blueprint founding (2009), education, upbringing
https://www.blueprintchurch.org/angela-lewis	Spouse (Angie Lewis)
https://myblvd.co/team/dhati-lewis/	MyBLVD role, "Vision and Multiplication Pastor"
https://www.namb.net/news/send-networks-dhati-lewis-leaving-namb-for-new-project/	Send Network President title, NAAF partnership, 2021 departure
https://www.namb.net/news/vance-pitman-to-lead-nambs-send-network/	Succession by Vance Pitman; tenure length
https://www.namb.net/news/new-book-advocates-for-christian-path-to-reconciliation/	Advocates quotes
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/trustees-record-aaeo-new-vps-top-namb-agenda/	Send Network VP appointment (Oct 2, 2018)
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/path-to-reconciliation-focus-of-advocates/	Advocate/aggravator framework
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/urban-engagement-sparks-namb-rebuild-partnership/	Rebuild Network (2011), Larry Grays, Kevin Ezell

Publishing / bibliographic

URL	Verifies
https://www.bhpbublishinggroup.com/product/among-wolves-2/	Among Wolves details, education
https://www.bhpbublishinggroup.com/product/advocates-2/advocates-2/	Advocates endorsers
https://www.amazon.com/Advocates-Narrow-Path-Racial-Reconciliation/dp/1535934670	Advocates ISBN/publisher/year
https://www.amazon.com/Among-Wolves-Disciple-Making-Dhati-Lewis/dp/1433644029	Among Wolves ISBN
https://www.amazon.com/Among-Wolves-Bible-Disciple-Making/dp/1462742831	Bible Study Book ISBN
https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/7211235.Dhati_Lewis	Bibliography, ratings, reach

Voice / interviews / teaching

URL	Verifies
https://saturatetheworld.com/2017/07/20/dont-just-start-church-establish-family/	Church-as-family ecclesiology
https://whereyafrom.org/episode/episode-56-a-blueprint-for-discipleship-in-an-urban-context-with-dhati-lewis/	Verbatim quotes, voice
https://www.christianpost.com/news/dhati-lewis-talks-disciple-making-in-the-urban-context.html	Interview / disciple-making

Digital presence

URL	Verifies
https://www.dhatilewis.com/wherelifeexists	Where Life Exists podcast
https://myblvdpodcast.podbean.com/	MyBLVD Podcast
https://www.youtube.com/@wherelifeexists	YouTube channel
https://www.instagram.com/dhati.lewis/	Instagram
https://x.com/dhati	Twitter/X
https://t4g.org/speakers/dhati-lewis/	T4G speaker
https://mosaixconference.com/speaker/dhati-lewis/	Mosaix speaker

Notes on excluded sources

Advocacy/oppositional sites (e.g., "Enemies Within the Church", thirtypiecesofsilver) appeared in search but were **not** used for factual claims due to their advocacy framing.

Dhati Lewis Research Collated

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/DHATI_LEWIS_RESEARCH_COLLATED.md`

Dhati Lewis — Movement Leader Research (Substrate)

Slug: `dhati-lewis`

Version: 2.0.0 (substrate)

Last updated: 2026-06-04

Purpose: Machine-readable corpus for identity resolution, relational traversal, conceptual indexing, and voice fidelity. Not a consulting report.

1. Identity

Field	Value	Source
Full legal name	Dhati Lewis (middle name "Baraka" appears on his personal Facebook as "Dhati Baraka Lewis" — self-published, probable not authoritative)	facebook.com/dhati.lewis
Known as	Dhati Lewis	dhatilewis.com/about
Born	unknown (no published birth date or year)	—
Birthplace	Born and raised in California	plantmidwest.com
Childhood	Raised in California; son of an NFL player (father's name not published); recruited to play football at the University of North Texas	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis , plantmidwest.com
Current location	Atlanta, Georgia	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Nationality	American	blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Heritage	Black / African American (self-described "a black pastor serving in an urban church")	Among Wolves (Amazon)
Primary roles	Founding/lead pastor, Blueprint Church (Atlanta); Founder & President, Rebuild Initiative Inc. / MyBLVD; former Vice President → President, Send Network (NAMB)	dhatilewis.com/about , myblvd.co
Primary organizations	Blueprint Church; Rebuild Initiative Inc. (MyBLVD Experience, MyBLVD Family, Known 360); North American Mission Board / Send Network (former)	dhatilewis.com/about
US sponsor (if applicable)	n/a (US-based)	—
Spouse / partner	Angie (Angela) Lewis	blueprintchurch.org/angela-lewis
Education	B.A., University of North Texas; M.A. in Cross-Cultural Ministry, Dallas Theological Seminary; D.Min. in Great Commission Mobilization, Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary (degree years unknown)	bhpublishinggroup.com , blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis
Children	Six named — Trinity, Jade, Briaiah, Dhati, Brayden, Nathaniel (one Blueprint bio says "seven"; six is best-supported)	authenticmanhood.com
Coined term (if applicable)	None verified. Signature phrase: vision to be "the last generation to [have to] leave the urban context for sound discipleship"	namb.net

2. Disambiguation

1 dominant public figure named Dhati Lewis — **subject is the pastor only**. "Dhati" is a rare given name, so cross-contamination is low.

#	Identity	Disambiguate with	Exclude
1	Dhati Lewis — pastor, church planter, author (Blueprint Church / Send Network)	"Blueprint Church", "Send Network", "Among Wolves", "Advocates"	—
2	"Dhati Lewis" college-football entry on Sports-Reference (page returned 403; could not verify) — may be the same person , given the pastor played football at UNT	"cfb", "college football stats"	confirm against ministry sources before merging

Reliable modifiers: Blueprint Church, Send Network / NAMB, Among Wolves, Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation, MyBLVD / Rebuild Initiative — these uniquely retrieve the subject. Distinct, unrelated names that surface in search (D.D. Lewis, Damione Lewis — NFL players) are NOT him.

3. Editorial bio

Dhati Lewis was born and raised in California, the son of an NFL player, and came to Texas on a football scholarship to the University of North Texas. Out of his collegiate years — chaplaincy to the UNT football team and early college ministry — came a vocation toward urban disciple-making, formalized through a Master's in Cross-Cultural Ministry at Dallas Theological Seminary and later a Doctor of Ministry in Great Commission Mobilization at Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary.

In 2009 he and roughly twenty-five others relocated to downtown Atlanta to found Blueprint Church, built on a conviction that the church "is not like family; it is family" and that disciple-making — not church-planting — is the engine of multiplication. He launched the Rebuild Network in 2011 to plant multi-ethnic churches in urban contexts, and articulated his disciple-making theology in *Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City* (B&H, 2017) and his approach to racial reconciliation in *Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation* (B&H, 2019).

From 2018 he led the North American Mission Board's Send Network — voted Vice President in October 2018 and later serving as President — before departing at the end of 2021 to focus on Blueprint and a new initiative, BLVD/MyBLVD, under the Rebuild Initiative, aimed at empowering disciple-makers in majority-minority, multiethnic communities. He hosts the *Where Life Exists* and *MyBLVD* podcasts and teaches widely across the church-planting ecosystem (T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential).

4. Timeline

Year(s)	Milestone	Organization / work	Source
(childhood)	Born and raised in California, son of an NFL player	—	plantmidwest.com
~early 1990s	Football scholarship to University of North Texas; later football chaplain, college pastor, planted a church in Texas	University of North Texas	blueprintchurch.org/dhatilewis
(grad school)	M.A. in Cross-Cultural Ministry	Dallas Theological Seminary	bhpublishinggroup.com
2009	Moved to Atlanta with ~25 others; founded Blueprint Church (launched downtown 2010)	Blueprint Church	blueprintchurch.org/dhatilewis , baptistpress.com
2011	Launched the Rebuild Network (urban church planting); NAMB partnership	Rebuild Network / NAMB	baptistpress.com
2013	In Plain Sight: A Primer for Reclaiming Discipleship in the Local Church (reported; unconfirmed)	Rebuild Network	Goodreads author page
~2016–2017	D.Min. in Great Commission Mobilization (described as "most recently received" in 2017)	Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary	bhpublishinggroup.com
2017	Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City + Bible Study Book + Leader Kit	B&H / LifeWay	bhpublishinggroup.com
Oct 2, 2018	Voted Vice President of Send Network by NAMB trustees (succeeding Jeff Christopherson)	NAMB / Send Network	baptistpress.com
2019	Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation; launched Send Network–NAAF diversity partnership	B&H / Send Network	baptistpress.com , namb.net
~2019–2021	Served as President of Send Network (~3 years leading the network)	Send Network	namb.net
End of 2021	Departed NAMB to launch BLVD/ MyBLVD; succeeded as Send Network president by Vance Pitman	Rebuild Initiative / NAMB	namb.net
2022–	Continues as Blueprint lead/vision pastor + Founder & President, Rebuild Initiative (MyBLVD, Known 360)	Blueprint / Rebuild Initiative	dhatilewis.com/about

5. Frameworks

Advocate vs. Aggravator

Field	Value
Introduced	2019, <i>Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation</i>
Components	(1) Rely on Christ; (2) Run to the tension; (3) Respond with dignity
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Framing for <i>Advocates</i> (B&H, 2019); used in his reconciliation teaching and conference talks
Source	baptistpress.com

An "advocate" pursues reconciliation by relying on Christ, running toward (not away from) racial tension, and responding with dignity; an "aggravator" deepens division out of self-interest, self-preservation, or self-vindication. The schema is drawn exegetically from Paul's letter to Philemon.

Eight Movements in Matthew (disciple-making model)

Field	Value
Introduced	2017, <i>Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City</i>
Components	Eight "movements" traced through Matthew's Gospel, from Jesus establishing His presence with His followers to mobilizing them to make disciples of all nations
Visual / model	Structured around Matthew's narrative arc
Adoption evidence	Basis of <i>Among Wolves</i> book + 8-session LifeWay Bible study + Leader Kit
Source	bhpublishinggroup.com

A disciple-making culture built by following eight movements in Matthew that turn passive church participants into active disciple-makers in the city.

Church as Family (ecclesiology)

Field	Value
Introduced	Developed in Among Wolves (2017); articulated in his Saturate essay (2017)
Components	Identity precedes activity; establish belonging/family before infrastructure; "if you make disciples the logical result is a church"
Visual / model	—
Adoption evidence	Blueprint Church's discipleship strategy: "develop healthy people who are growing in the Gospel, in the context of family, while living on mission"
Source	saturatetheworld.com

"The church is not like family; it is family." Disciple-making, not church-planting, is the engine: plant a church and you are not guaranteed disciples, but make disciples and a church (family) is the logical result.

The 7 Steps of an Urban Missionary

Field	Value
Introduced	MyBLVD Podcast (with Missie Branch)
Components	A seven-stop sequence framing the formation of an "urban missionary" (individual stops not fully catalogued in sources reached)
Visual / model	Podcast series arc
Adoption evidence	MyBLVD Podcast / Rebuild Initiative content
Source	myblvdpodcast.podbean.com

A named teaching arc on MyBLVD that sequences the journey of an "urban missionary."
(Component detail not fully documented — see Open questions.)

6. Bibliography

Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Key themes	One sentence	URL
Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation	Dhati Lewis	B&H Books	2019	9781535934671 (hc); 9781535934688 (ebook)	racial reconciliation, advocacy, Philemon, heart posture	Using Paul's letter to Philemon, Lewis argues Christians must become advocates — not aggravators — pursuing reconciliation by relying on Christ, running to the tension, and responding with dignity.	Amazon
Among Wolves — Leader Kit: Disciple Making in the City	Dhati Lewis	LifeWay	2017	9781462742844	disciple- making, small-group teaching	Leader companion kit to the Among Wolves Bible study.	Amazon
Among Wolves — Bible Study Book: Disciple Making in the City	Dhati Lewis	LifeWay	2017	9781462742837	disciple- making, urban ministry	8-session Bible study companion to Among Wolves.	Amazon
Among Wolves: Disciple- Making in the City	Dhati Lewis	B&H Books	2017	9781433644023	disciple- making, the city, church as family, mobilization	Walking through eight movements in Matthew, Lewis equips leaders to build a disciple- making culture that turns passive participants into active	B&H

Title	Author(s)	Publisher	Year	ISBN-13	Key themes	One sentence	URL
						disciple-makers in the city.	
In Plain Sight: A Primer for Reclaiming Discipleship in the Local Church	Dhati Lewis	Rebuild Network (reported)	2013 (reported)	unknown	reclaiming discipleship, local-church disciple-making	Precursor to Among Wolves; a primer on reclaiming local-church discipleship (reportedly a free e-book).	Goodreads

Summary: 5 entries (4 unique works + 1 study/leader-kit pair); all solo-authored; publishers B&H and LifeWay (2017) plus a reported 2013 Rebuild Network primer; ~256 Goodreads ratings across all works (Advocates 4.07/175; Among Wolves 3.79/76; In Plain Sight 4.50/2). Lewis also wrote the **foreword** to Responsible Sibling by Jorge Mendoza (ISBN-13 9781546499428) — not an authored title. Sources: [Goodreads author page](#), [bhpublishinggroup.com](#).

Theme map

Theme	Primary works
Disciple-making	Among Wolves (+ Bible study/leader kit), In Plain Sight
The city / urban ministry	Among Wolves
Church as family	Among Wolves; Saturate essay; foreword to Responsible Sibling
Racial reconciliation	Advocates
Multiethnic church / leadership across the cultural divide	Advocates; positioning/bio
Church planting & multiplication	Send Network role; Among Wolves

Content analysis (structured)

Tier	Theme	Description	Key works	Centrality (1-10)
Primary	Disciple-making in the urban context	Disciple-making (not church-planting) as the engine of multiplication, centered on the city	Among Wolves, In Plain Sight	10
Primary	Church as family	Ecclesiology in which the church is family; identity/belonging precede activity	Among Wolves, Saturate essay	8
Secondary	Racial reconciliation	A Christ-centered "narrow path" of advocacy over political aggravation	Advocates	8
Secondary	Multiethnic / cross-cultural leadership	Equipping leaders to "navigate the cultural divide"	Advocates, bio/positioning	6
Emerging	Urban missionary formation	Forming "urban missionaries" via MyBLVD	MyBLVD Podcast, BLVD initiative	5

Recommended reading order

Order	Work	Rationale
1	Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City	The core thesis — disciple-making and church-as-family — that frames everything else.
2	Among Wolves — Bible Study Book	Applies the eight-movements model in a group/practitioner format.
3	Advocates: The Narrow Path to Racial Reconciliation	Extends the disciple-making vision into reconciliation and the multiethnic church.
4	In Plain Sight	Early primer; read last as the seed-form precursor to Among Wolves.

7. Voice fingerprint

Weighted markers (must sum to 100%)

Marker	Target	Weight
Triadic, framework-driven structure (memorable three-part schemes)	≥ 0.7	30%
Exegetical anchoring (whole book built on one biblical book; chapter-and-verse inline)	≥ 0.7	25%
Narrative / personal testimony framing	0.5–0.8	20%
Direct second-person address to practitioners	0.5–0.8	15%
"Run to the tension" both/and move (holds binaries rather than resolving them)	≥ 0.6	10%
Coherence target	≥ 0.75	—

Hallmark lexicon (9+ terms)

disciple-making, disciple-makers, the city / urban context, urban missionary, run to the tension, advocate / ministry of reconciliation, respond with dignity, rely on Christ, the church as family, navigate the cultural divide, holistic disciple-makers, the last generation to leave the urban context

Antithesis prohibition (non-negotiable)

Do not collapse Lewis's deliberately-held both/and tensions into a one-sided "not X but Y" resolution. His signature move is to name a binary — context vs. theology, comfort vs. obedience, fleeing vs. staying — and then refuse to choose a side, calling the listener to "run to the tension" rather than past it. Writing in his voice that dissolves a tension by picking the "correct" pole misreads him; he holds the tension as the doorway to mission. Derived from his Where Ya From? Ep. 56 framing ("either I was around people who got my context but didn't have that same commitment to theology and mission, or... they didn't get my context").

Source: whereyafrom.org.

Representative quotes (5+)

"We need to be careful with ministry because sometimes our gifts will take us to places that our character can't handle." — Among Wolves: Disciple-Making in the City ([Goodreads](#))

"Cities are not only diverse culturally, but also socioeconomically. In urban settings, in a one-mile area, one can see extreme poverty intertwined with extreme wealth..." — Among Wolves ([Goodreads](#))

"Racial division is a real problem that demands real solutions that can lead to real transformation." — NAMB feature on Advocates ([namb.net](#))

"For us to become advocates, we must do the hard work of facing anything that defines us that is divisive and not of Christ." — NAMB feature on Advocates (namb.net)

"And many of us define God's will by the path of least resistance... our North Stars are comfort, and we're addicted to our comfort." — Where Ya From? Ep. 56, 2023-10-17 (whereyafrom.org)

"We wanted to establish a blueprint... a church that's planting other churches because we want to be a church that's going to be the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship." — Where Ya From? Ep. 56 (whereyafrom.org)

8. Theological positioning

Domain	Position
Tradition	Southern Baptist (SBC); trained at Dallas Theological Seminary and Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary. No explicit "Reformed" self-identification found.
Ecclesiology	Church-as-family over church-as-institution; identity/belonging precede activity; critiques building organizational infrastructure before authentic community
Missiology	Urban disciple-making and multiplication; "a healthy, multiplying church in every community"; equipping urban and majority-minority leaders
Leadership	Mobilize passive participants into active, "holistic" disciple-makers; teach leaders to "navigate the cultural divide"
Christology	Christ-centered reconciliation; "rely on Christ" as the first mark of an advocate (not separately systematized in sources)
Anthropology / formation	Disciple-making forms the person in the context of family and mission; character must keep pace with gifting
Culture	Racial reconciliation as a Christ-centered "narrow path"; heart posture over political positioning; shared responsibility for reconciliation

Distinctive claims (bulleted)

- Disciple-making — not church-planting — is the engine: "if you make disciples the logical result is a church/family." (saturatetheworld.com)
- The church is literally family, not merely like family. (saturatetheworld.com)
- Reconciliation is a Christ-centered "narrow path" of advocacy, distinguished from politically-driven "aggravation." (baptistpress.com)
- Vision to be "the last generation to leave the urban context for sound discipleship." (namb.net)

9. Intellectual genealogy

Upstream influences

Person	Ideas adopted	Source
Jeff Christopherson	Send Network missiology / church-planting strategy (predecessor and leader Lewis served under)	baptistpress.com
Kevin Ezell (NAMB President)	NAMB "Send North America" strategy; champion of the NAMB-Rebuild partnership	baptistpress.com

Named theological/authorial mentors are not documented in sources reached; his training pedigree (Dallas Theological Seminary, Southeastern) situates him in conservative evangelical / SBC streams. (See Open questions.)

Downstream impact (documented)

Channel	Evidence
Rebuild Network / Initiative	Founded 2011 to plant multi-ethnic urban churches; partnered with NAMB's Send North America strategy (baptistpress.com)
Send Network leadership	Drove ethnic diversity among church planters; launched the Send Network-NAAF partnership (2019; first NAAF-sourced residents assessed Nov 2021) (namb.net)
BLVD / MyBLVD	Departed NAMB to "develop and mentor young leaders who will plant churches in the urban context" (namb.net)

Caveat: no reliable Send Network church-plant count is attributable specifically to Lewis's tenure (the 70+/300+ figures in the succession coverage belong to Vance Pitman's Hope Church, not Lewis).

Peer dialogue

Person	Relationship	Shared themes
Larry Grays	Rebuild Initiative VP; pastor, Midtown Bridge Church (Atlanta)	Urban church planting
Vance Pitman	Successor as Send Network president; publicly endorsed by Lewis	Church planting / multiplication
Greg Perkins	NAAF / Send Network-NAAF partnership	Ethnic diversity in church planting
Missie Branch	Co-host, MyBLVD Podcast	Urban missionary formation
Daniel Yang / Daniel Im / Michael "Stew" Stewart	Church-planting ecosystem peers (Send Institute / NewChurches / Verge); endorsed Advocates	Church multiplication

Constructive tensions (documented)

No documented constructive tensions from neutral, reliable sources. (Advocacy-framed critiques of his racial-reconciliation emphasis exist within intra-SBC "anti-woke" channels; not used here as factual sources.)

Comparable authors (reach / genre, not affinity scores)

Author	Overlap
Derwin Gray	Multiethnic church; reconciliation; endorser of Advocates
Bryan Loritts	Urban/multiethnic ministry; Where Life Exists guest
Mark DeYmaz	Multiethnic church movement (Mosaix network)
Daniel Im	Church multiplication / disciple-making resources

10. Network graph

Co-authors

Person	Joint works	Edge weight	Notes
—	—	—	No co-authored books; all titles sole-authored. Foreword for Jorge Mendoza's Responsible Sibling (collaboration, not co-authorship).

Endorsements received (sample)

From	For	Year	URL / note
J.D. Greear	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Derwin Gray	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Kevin Ezell	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Daniel Yang	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Daniel Im	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com
Michael "Stew" Stewart	Advocates	2019	bhpublishinggroup.com

Organizational affiliations

- **Blueprint Church** (Atlanta) — founding / lead (vision & multiplication) pastor, 2009–present
- **Rebuild Initiative Inc. / Rebuild Network** — founder & president, ~2011–present (parent of MyBLVD Experience, MyBLVD Family, Known 360)
- **MyBLVD / BLVD ("Boulevard")** — founder & president, 2021–present

- **North American Mission Board / Send Network** — VP (Oct 2018) → President, until end of 2021
- **Send Institute** — author/contributor
- **University of North Texas** (B.A.; football chaplain); **Dallas Theological Seminary** (M.A.); **Southeastern Baptist Theological Seminary** (D.Min.)

JSON graph (nodes + edges)

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  {"id": "derwin-gray", "name": "Derwin Gray", "type": "person"},
  {"id": "daniel-yang", "name": "Daniel Yang", "type": "person"},
  {"id": "daniel-im", "name": "Daniel Im", "type": "person"},
  {"id": "michael-stewart", "name": "Michael \"Stew\" Stewart", "type": "person"},
  {"id": "jorge-mendoza", "name": "Jorge Mendoza", "type": "person"}
]
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11. Reach metrics

Signal	Value	Date	Source
Goodreads ratings — Advocates	4.07 avg, 175 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads ratings — Among Wolves	3.79 avg, 76 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads ratings — In Plain Sight	4.50 avg, 2 ratings	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads total	~256 ratings, ~40 reviews (all works)	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Goodreads author followers	4	2026-06-04	Goodreads
Instagram followers (@dhati.lewis)	~3,592 (search snapshot; unconfirmed by direct fetch)	2026-06-04	instagram.com/dhati.lewis
Twitter/X followers (@dhati)	unknown	2026-06-04	x.com/dhati
YouTube subscribers (@wherelifeexists)	unknown	2026-06-04	youtube.com/@wherelifeexists
Podcasts hosted	3 (Where Life Exists, MyBLVD, We Are Send Network)	2026-06-04	see Distribution inventory
Verified guest appearances	2+ (Where Ya From?; The Gospel, Culture & Me)	2026-06-04	whereyafrom.org
Wikipedia presence	None found	2026-06-04	search

12. Distribution inventory

Books: Advocates (B&H, 2019); Among Wolves + Bible Study Book + Leader Kit (B&H/LifeWay, 2017); In Plain Sight (Rebuild Network, reported 2013); foreword to Responsible Sibling (Jorge Mendoza). See §6.

Articles & blogs: ERLC author archive (erlc.com); MyBLVD (myblvd.co/author/dhati); Saturate (saturatetheworld.com/author/dhati); Outreach Magazine voices/feature; Christian Post interview (christianpost.com).

Audio: Podcasts hosted — Where Life Exists (dhatilewis.com/wherelifeexists), MyBLVD Podcast (with Missie Branch; myblvdpodcast.podbean.com), We Are Send Network (with Noah Oldham & Heiden Ratner). Guest: Where Ya From? Ep. 56 (Christianity Today, 2023); The Gospel, Culture & Me Ep. 16. Recorded teaching on Moody Audio.

Video: YouTube @wherelifeexists ([youtube.com/@wherelifeexists](https://www.youtube.com/@wherelifeexists)); MyBLVD episodes on YouTube.

Courses & assessments: Among Wolves 8-session Bible study + Leader Kit (LifeWay, 2017).

Websites & orgs: dhatilewis.com, blueprintchurch.org, myblvd.co; author pages at [Amazon](#), [B&H](#), [Goodreads](#); speaker pages at [T4G](#), [Mosaix](#), [Verge](#), [Exponential](#).

Social: Instagram [@dhati.lewis](#); Twitter/X [@dhati](#); Facebook [dhati.lewis](#); YouTube [@wherelifeexists](#).

Academic / papers: None found.

Translations: None found.

Content gap table (factual state only)

Asset	State	Source
In Plain Sight (2013)	No retail ISBN or publisher page located; reportedly a free e-book	Goodreads
Wikipedia	No dedicated page exists	search 2026-06-04
Audiobook editions	Not confirmed for any title	—
Academic publications	None found	—

13. Sources (provenance)

URL	Verifies
https://www.dhatilewis.com/about	Roles, Rebuild Initiative/MyBLVD, current positioning
https://www.blueprintchurch.org/dhati-lewis	Bio, Blueprint founding (2009), education, upbringing
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/trustees-record-aaeo-new-vps-top-namb-agenda/	Send Network VP appointment (Oct 2, 2018)
https://www.namb.net/news/send-networks-dhati-lewis-leaving-namb-for-new-project/	President title, NAAF partnership, departure end of 2021
https://www.namb.net/news/vance-pitman-to-lead-nambs-send-network/	Succession by Vance Pitman; ~3-year tenure
https://www.bhpgublishinggroup.com/product/among-wolves-2/	Among Wolves details, education (DTS, Southeastern)
https://www.amazon.com/Advocates-Narrow-Path-Racial-Reconciliation/dp/1535934670	Advocates details
https://www.bhpgublishinggroup.com/product/advocates-2/advocates-2/	Advocates endorsers
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/path-to-reconciliation-focus-of-advocates/	Advocate/aggravator framework
https://saturatetheworld.com/2017/07/20/dont-just-start-church-establish-family/	Church-as-family ecclesiology
https://www.goodreads.com/author/show/7211235.Dhati_Lewis	Bibliography, ratings, reach metrics
https://whereyafrom.org/episode/episode-56-a-blueprint-for-discipleship-in-an-urban-context-with-dhati-lewis/	Verbatim quotes, voice
https://www.baptistpress.com/resource-library/news/urban-engagement-sparks-namb-rebuild-partnership/	Rebuild Network (2011), Larry Grays, Kevin Ezell

Digital-presence file pointers (for traceability): This substrate was assembled from cold-start web research (no on-disk per-topic source files existed at generation time). Per-topic files under `profile/`, `content/`, `network/`, `analysis/`, `digital-presence/` may be authored later; this document is the consolidated read surface.

14. Open questions

- Date / year of birth — unknown.
- Father's name (the NFL player) — unknown.
- Exact graduation years for B.A., M.A., and D.Min. (D.Min. likely ~2016–2017) — unknown.
- Number of children — sources conflict (six named vs. "seven"); six is best-supported.

- Middle name "Baraka" — only from his own Facebook; not in any institutional bio.
- Exact date he transitioned from VP to President of Send Network — unknown.
- Verified Send Network church-plant count attributable to his tenure — not found.
- Among Wolves endorsers — could not be retrieved (publisher/retail pages did not list blurbs).
- In Plain Sight — ISBN, publisher, and 2013 year unconfirmed by any retail/publisher page.
- Components of "The 7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" — not fully catalogued in sources reached.
- Whether the Sports-Reference college-football "Dhati Lewis" is the same person — unconfirmed (page blocked).
- Social follower/subscriber counts for Twitter/X, Facebook, YouTube — not visible; Instagram (~3,592) from a search snapshot only.

Welcome-Letter-2026-06-09

`docs/movement_leader_research/_onboarded_leaders/dhati-lewis/welcome-letter-2026-06-09.md`

Dhati

You have built one of the most coherent disciple-making bodies of work in the American urban church. Among Wolves in 2017, its companion Bible study and leader kit, Advocates in 2019, the In Plain Sight primer in 2013 — and underneath them, fifteen years of practice: Blueprint Church, founded in Atlanta in 2009; the Rebuild Initiative you launched and lead; three years carrying the North American Mission Board's Send Network from Vice President to President. Today you are Vision and Multiplication Pastor at Blueprint and founder and president of MyBLVD. That last role matters most for what follows.

All of it is somewhere. None of it is in one place. Among Wolves sits at B&H and on Amazon; the Bible study and leader kit are at LifeWay; In Plain Sight, the seed of everything after, has no ISBN and no product page — it has effectively fallen off the map. Your audio is split four ways: Where Life Exists on your own site and YouTube, the MyBLVD Podcast you co-host with Missie Branch on Podbean and iHeart, We Are Send Network on Apple. Three shows, four hubs, no single archive. Your essays scatter across ERLC, Saturate, Outreach, and Christian Post — and several of those archives won't load for a search engine, so the catalogue is invisible. The teaching is worse off, because it lives on other people's stages: T4G, Mosaix, Verge, Exponential, Moody Audio. The relational layer fragments the same way. The planters you raised at Send Network live in NAMB's systems; the leaders you form now live in the MyBLVD roster; the congregation lives at Blueprint; and the people who vouch for the work — J.D. Greear, Derwin Gray, Daniel Im, Vance Pitman, Missie Branch — exist only as scattered endorsements and co-hosted episodes, alongside the far larger rolodex in your phone and memory. What is missing is the layer above all of it: the one place that lets a reader move from any single piece to every other, and lets people stay with you after they leave the network that introduced them.

The largest pool of value you have is also the one most likely to go unwritten. The "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary," as far as anyone outside your own rooms can tell, is not written down anywhere public; it lives in your head and in the cohorts you walk through it. So does the reasoning behind the Advocate-and-Aggravator triad, the eight movements you trace through Matthew, and the decision — made and re-made for fifteen years — to keep a church planted in the urban context instead of following the exodus out. The case studies behind Blueprint, the judgment calls behind leading a national network and then handing it on, the same conversation you have had a thousand times with a young planter in a hard neighborhood: none of it is anywhere a stranger can find.

This is where Movemental's AI does work that was not previously possible. The inventory you just read — the books traced across B&H and LifeWay and the gap where In Plain Sight should be, the podcast catalogue mapped across four platforms, the essays located in archives that won't crawl — was compiled by AI sitting with your public corpus for the weeks it would take a

human researcher to do the same. The same approach now turns toward what is not yet public: interview transcripts that capture the "7 Stops" in your own words, course-note extraction, dictation that becomes a draft and a draft that becomes an essay — the embodied layer surfaced at your pace rather than a publisher's. The AI does not replace your voice. Every draft is yours to edit, refuse, or rewrite. The tools do the inventorying and the connective tissue. The authorship stays yours.

This is what the dashboard is built to do, and what we will do with you. First, aggregate: pull the books and the Bible study, the In Plain Sight material, the three podcasts, the ERLC and Saturate essays, the conference sessions, and the frameworks as they surface into one searchable home. Second, interconnect: trace the real chains, so Among Wolves points to the eight movements in Matthew, which point to the Where Life Exists episodes that work them out, which point to the Saturate essay where you insisted the church "is not like family; it is family," which points back to the disciple-making argument the whole thing rests on. Third, repurpose: the "7 Stops of an Urban Missionary" becomes a public sequence instead of an oral tradition; the MyBLVD Podcast back-catalogue becomes a searchable teaching archive; In Plain Sight gets a real home and a pathway built around it; the conference talks become an archive under your own name. Fourth, amplify: the SEO and network effects that arrive once the frameworks are findable in one place, so the references point back to you. The work this season is not authorship. It is translation of what you have already authored into a form practitioners can actually reach.

A year from now, dhatilewis.com looks different. It is no longer a landing page with a dormant newsletter signup; it is the front door to the whole body of work. A disciple-making hub gathers Among Wolves, its Bible study, the urban-missionary pathway, the Where Life Exists and MyBLVD episodes, and a list people can actually join. In Plain Sight is archived and readable under your name for the first time in years. The eight movements and the Advocate-and-Aggravator triad stand as linkable references instead of pages buried in a book. And a church planter in Memphis who has never heard of Send Network or Rebuild searches how to make disciples in the city, finds the Among Wolves pathway on a Tuesday morning, and starts working through it that afternoon.

This is your next season. The work ahead is not another book; it is making the disciple-making vision you have already built reach the planters it was written for. Being Blueprint's Vision and Multiplication Pastor and the president of MyBLVD does not compete with that work — it is the reason it has to happen now, because the next generation of urban missionaries you are mentoring cannot yet find, in one place, the body of work you would hand them. Right now they cannot.

— Movemental